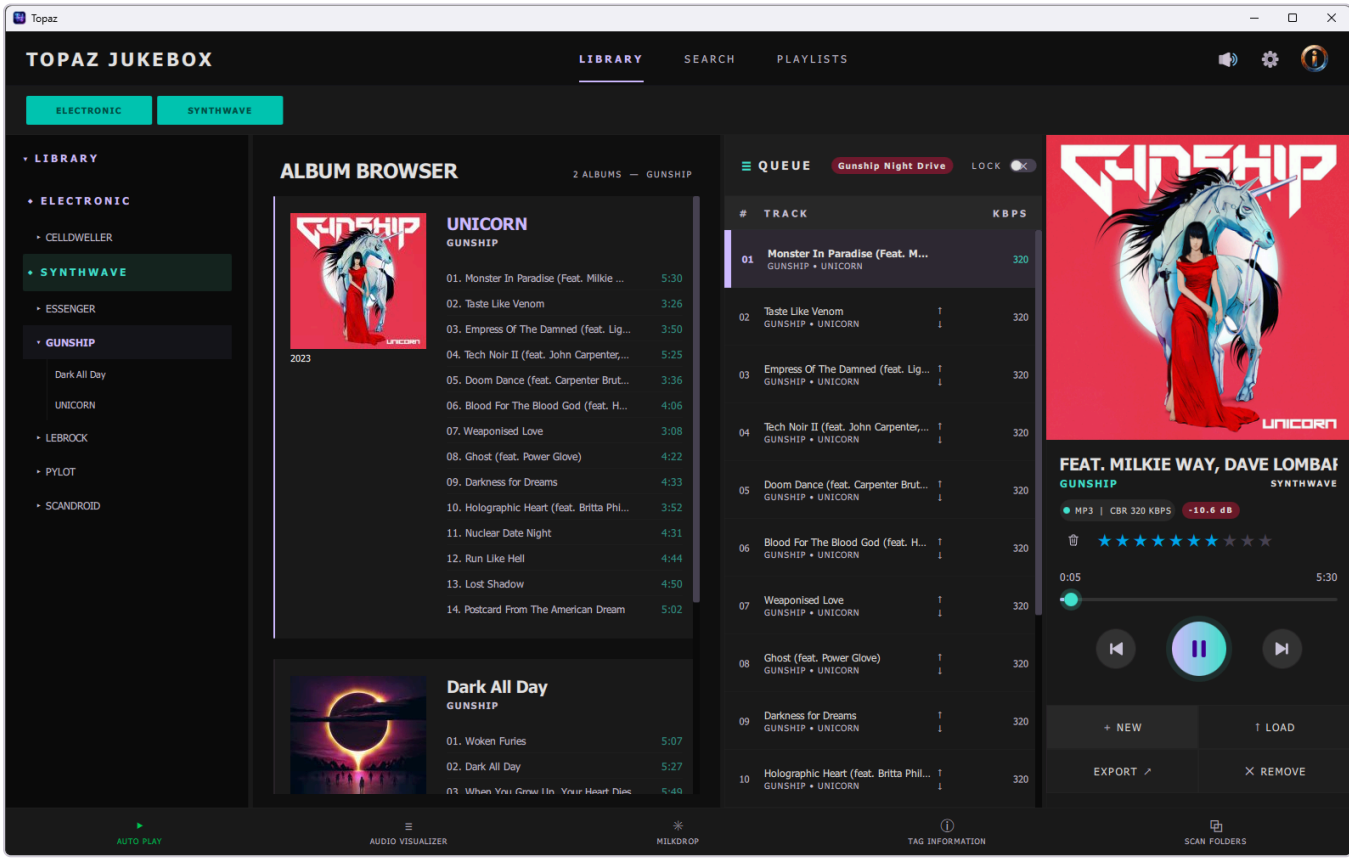
Topaz User Guide

Topaz Jukebox — Version 1.1.0 · for Windows 10/11 and Linux



Topaz is a desktop jukebox for your own music collection. It plays **FLAC, MP3 and Opus** files, organizes them by **Genre** → **Artist** → **Album**, plays them from a **queue**, and keeps **playlists** in the open XSPF format. On top of that it offers ratings, an automatic **AUTO PLAY** mode, crossfades, loudness correction, a bar visualizer, **Milkdrop** visuals, and detachable panes for a second screen.

This guide explains everything you can do with Topaz 1.1.0, step by step. The screenshots were taken with Topaz 1.1.0 on Windows; on Linux Topaz looks the same apart from fonts and the window frame.

Document history	
October 2026	First edition, for Topaz 1.0.0
October 2026	Second edition, for Topaz 1.1.0 — see What is new in this version

What is new in this version

- **Let Topaz find your genres:** Setup → GENRES → **SCAN FOLDERS** lists every genre in your music folders; pick the ones you want. Up to 48 genres and 40 genre buttons.
- **Always measure** loudness instead of trusting ReplayGain / R128 tags (Audiophile loudness correction).
- **Create M3U Playlist** when exporting — for car stereos that read playlist files.
- **VBR / CBR** shown for MP3s in NowPlaying, with the correct average bitrate for VBR files.

- **Modify the Rating …** (Setup → MISC) can now lock your ratings against accidental clicks.
- **Redesigned** Play/Pause, Previous and Next buttons.
- **Panel sizes** are remembered separately for the window and for full screen.
- **Fine-tune a pane's position** with the arrow keys.

The first start of 1.1.0 re-reads your MP3 files once in the background (for the bitrate information); the library stays usable meanwhile.

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Getting Topaz running

Topaz needs no installer. It comes as a folder that you copy anywhere you like — your hard disk, another drive, or a USB stick — and start from there.

Windows

1. Copy the Topaz folder to any location.
2. Double-click `Topaz.exe`.

That's all. Everything Topaz needs is inside the folder.

Linux

1. Copy the Topaz Linux folder (`deploy-linux`) to any location.
2. Start Topaz with `./run-topaz.sh` (not `topaz-bin` directly — the script tells Topaz where its own libraries are).
3. Optional: run `./install-topaz-launcher.sh` once. It adds Topaz to your desktop's application menu, with its icon.

More Linux details are in `README-Linux.txt` inside the folder. Topaz has been tested on Linux Mint 22 (Cinnamon, X11) and Ubuntu Studio.

Optional extras you can add yourself

Topaz works out of the box. Three optional add-ons unlock extra features. They are **not included** for licensing reasons — download them yourself and place them **next to** `Topaz.exe` (Windows) or **next to** `topaz-bin` (Linux).

Add-on	Files	What it unlocks
BASS Audio Library (un4seen.com)	Windows: `bass.dll`, `bassflac.dll`, `bassopus.dll` — Linux: `libbass.so`, `libbassflac.so`, `libbassopus.so`	The alternative playback engine **BASS Audio Library**, required for Auto Loudness Correction and Replay Gain export (see Sound settings)
BASS_FX (same site)	`bass_fx.dll` / `libbass_fx.so`	The "Consistent Background Music" loudness strategy
ffmpeg (ffmpeg.org)	`ffmpeg.exe` / `ffmpeg` — on Linux simply `sudo apt install ffmpeg`	**Convert to MP3** when exporting a playlist. The build must include the LAME MP3 encoder (the common Windows builds and the Linux packages do)

Where Topaz keeps its data

Topaz **never changes your music files**. Everything it remembers lives in its own folder:

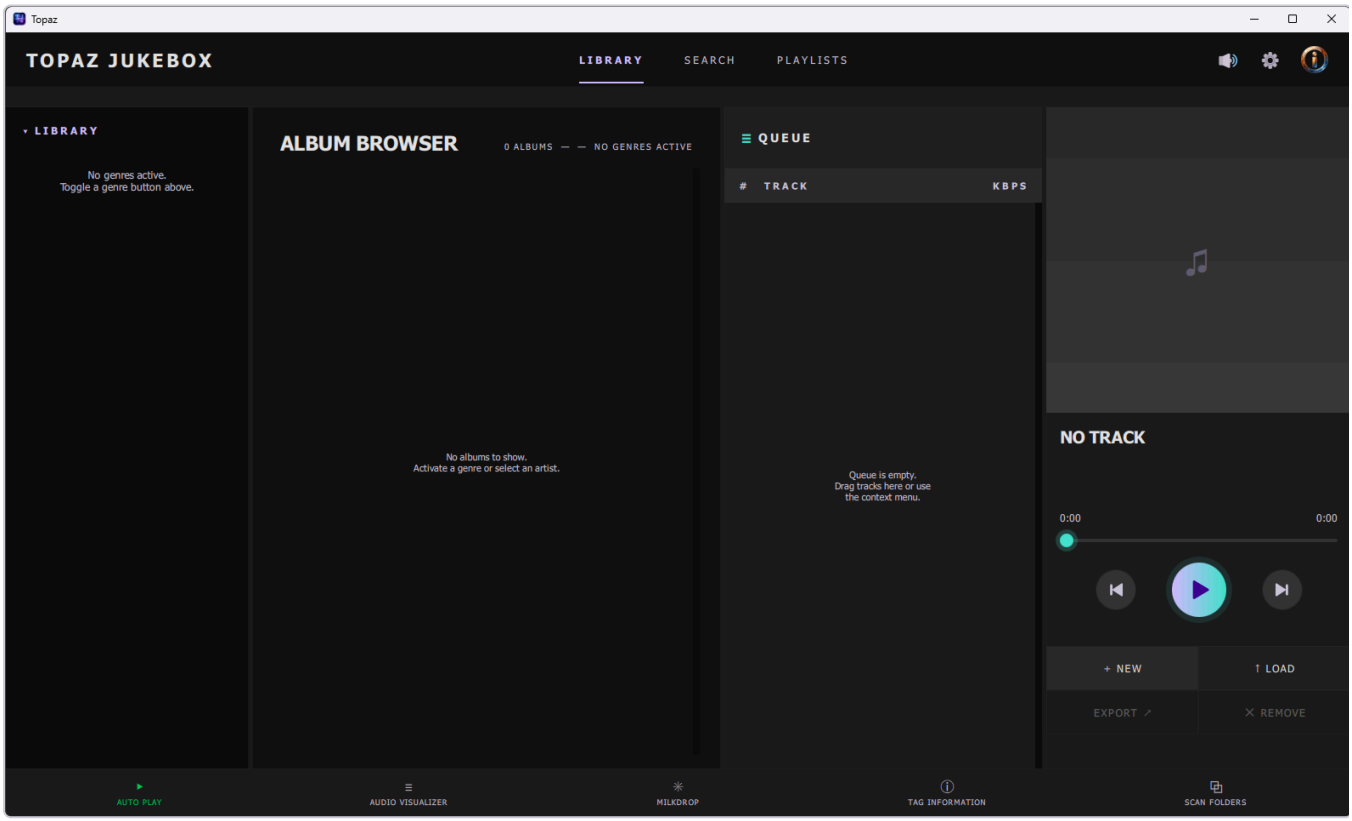
- Windows: `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Topaz\`
- Linux: `~/.config/Topaz/`

File	Contents
`Topaz.config`	All settings, the window layout
`Topaz.library.json`	The scanned library (so Topaz starts instantly)
`Topaz.rating.json`	Your ratings
`Topaz.volumeNormalization.json`	Loudness values (only with Auto Loudness Correction)
`playlists\*.xml`	Your playlists

To save all of this in one file, use **Backup** (see Maintenance and backup).

First start

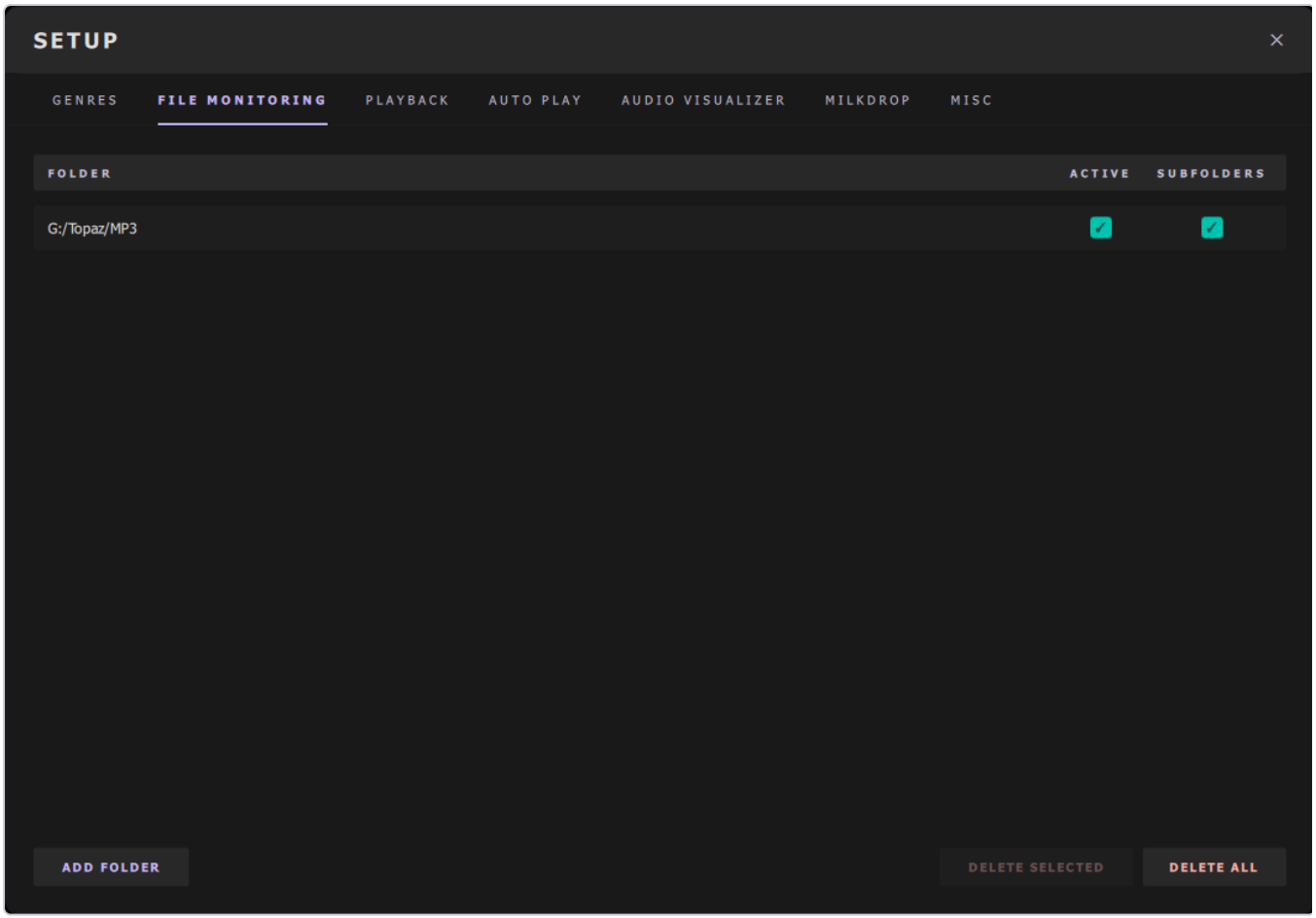
On the very first start Topaz is empty: it doesn't know yet where your music is or which genres you want to see.



Setting it up takes three steps, all in the **Setup** dialog. Open it with the **gear icon** ⚙ in the top-right corner.

Step 1: add your music folders

1. On the **FILE MONITORING** tab, click **ADD FOLDER**.
2. Choose the folder that holds your music.



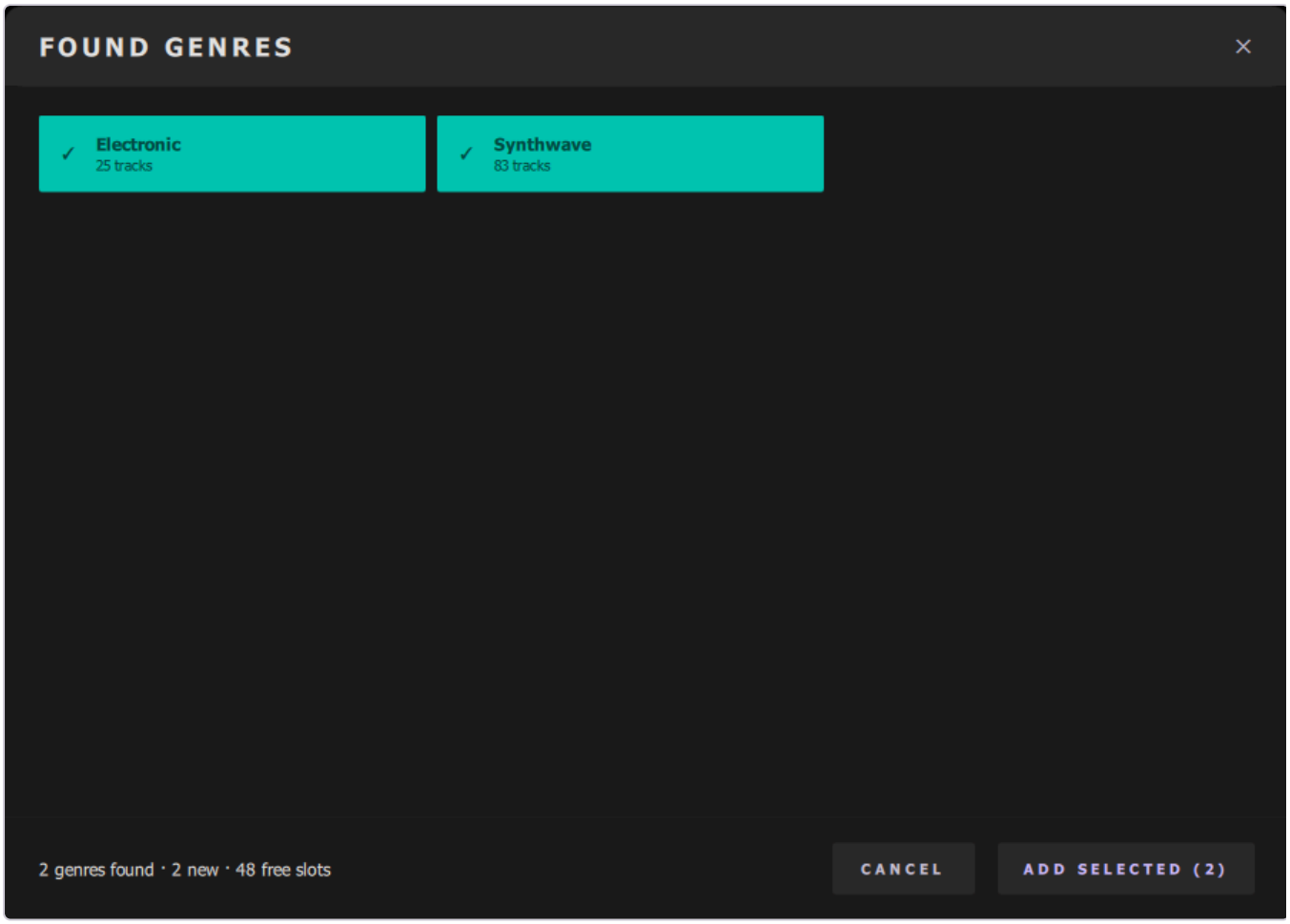
- **ACTIVE** — untick to exclude a folder from scanning without removing it.
- **SUBFOLDERS** — include all subfolders (the usual case).
- If a folder lives on a drive that isn't connected (an external disk, a USB stick), its row is dimmed. It comes back by itself when the drive is connected again — even under a different drive letter.

Step 2: add your genres

Topaz organizes music by the **genre tag** of each file. Only genres you add here appear in Topaz.

The easy way: let Topaz find your genres

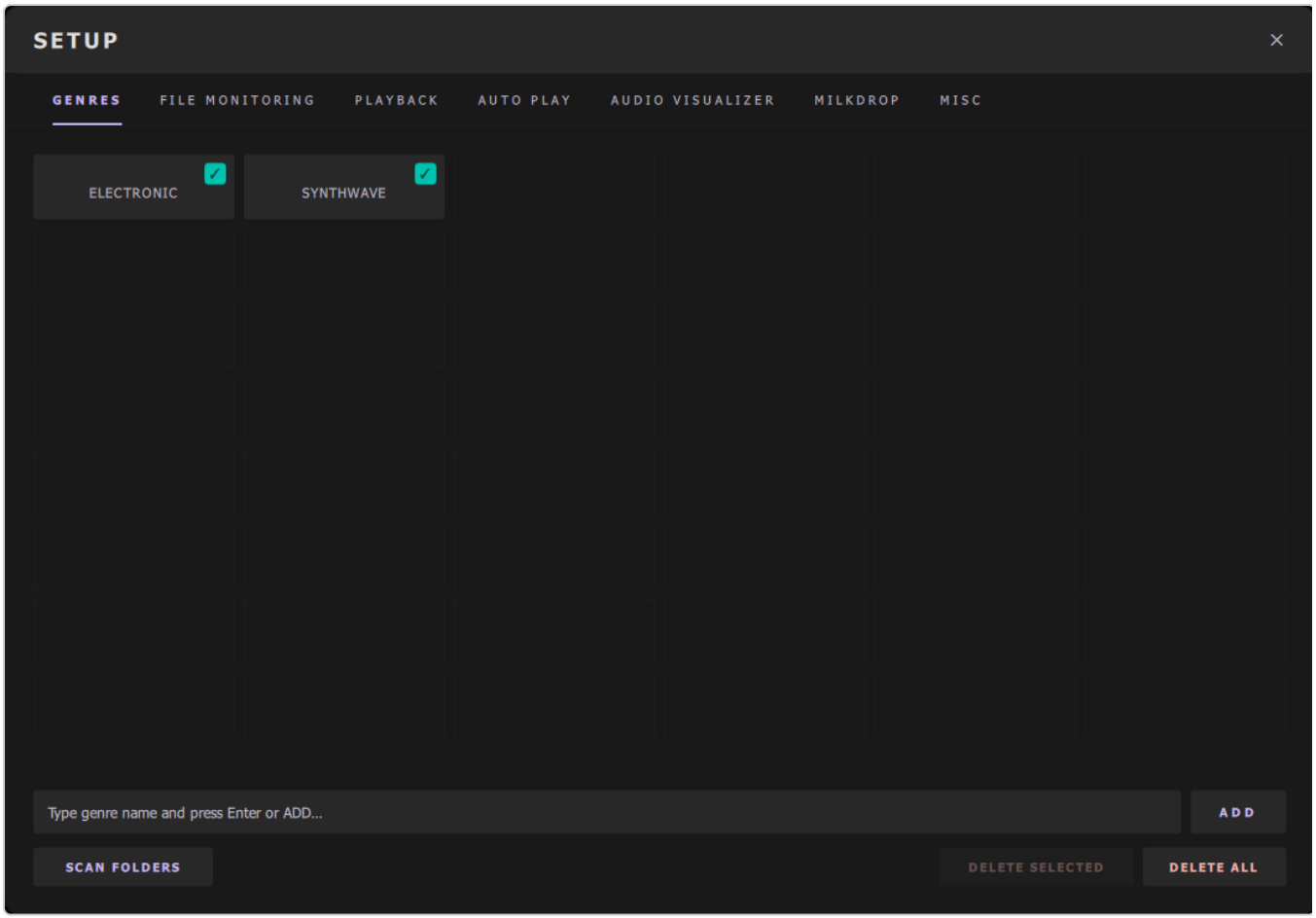
1. Switch to the **GENRES** tab and click **SCAN FOLDERS** (bottom left). It is available as soon as at least one music folder is ticked **ACTIVE** and connected.
2. The **FOUND GENRES** window reads the genre tags of all files in your active folders. Every genre appears right away with its number of tracks while the scan is still running; a progress bar and **STOP** are at the bottom (STOP keeps what was found so far).
3. Click the genres you want — you don't have to wait for the scan to finish. Genres you have already added are dimmed ("already in GENRES"). You can pick as many as there are free places.
4. Click **ADD SELECTED**.



Genres are shown exactly as they are written in your files (for a tag with several genres, the first one). Files without any genre tag are counted at the bottom. The scan only reads your files, it never changes them.

Typing a genre by hand

1. On the **GENRES** tab, type a genre name — exactly as it appears in your files' genre tags, upper/lower case doesn't matter — and press **Enter** or click **ADD**.
2. Repeat for every genre you want.



Good to know:

- A file counts for **exactly one** genre. If a tag holds several genres (for example `Rock/Pop` or `Rock;Pop`), Topaz uses the **first** one.
- Files whose genre is not in this list are ignored. This is deliberate: you decide which parts of a large collection Topaz shows.
- Up to **48** genres can be configured. The checkbox in each cell decides whether that genre gets a button in the genre bar of the main window (up to **40** buttons, 10 per row — with more than 30, a fourth row appears). Unticking it only hides the button — the genre's music stays in the library.
- Drag a genre cell to another position to change the order of the genre buttons.
- Select a cell and click **DELETE SELECTED** to remove a genre, or **DELETE ALL** to start over.

Step 3: scan

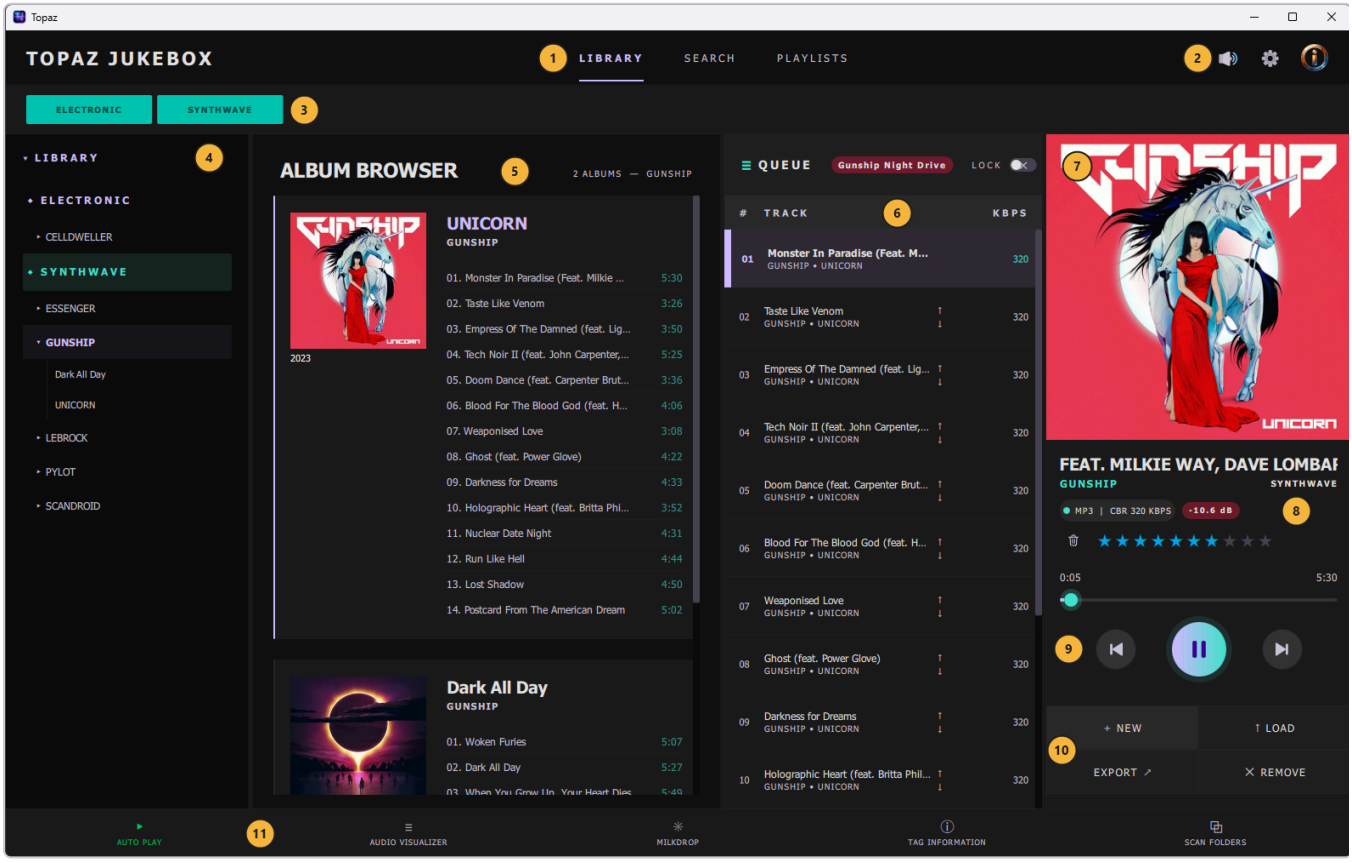
Close the Setup dialog with the ✕. Because the folder list or the genres changed, Topaz **scans automatically** — also right after you added genres from FOUND GENRES. You can always start a scan yourself with **SCAN FOLDERS** in the bottom-right corner of the main window.

While Topaz is running it also watches your folders: music added or removed there shows up by itself after a couple of seconds.

Tip — watch a scan happen: turn on **Visual Folder Scanning** in Setup → **MISC**. A SCAN FOLDERS window then appears during every scan, showing the folder being read and a progress bar, and closes itself when the scan is done. (A small library is scanned so quickly that the window may only flash briefly.)

Your library is now ready. Click a genre button to see it.

The main window

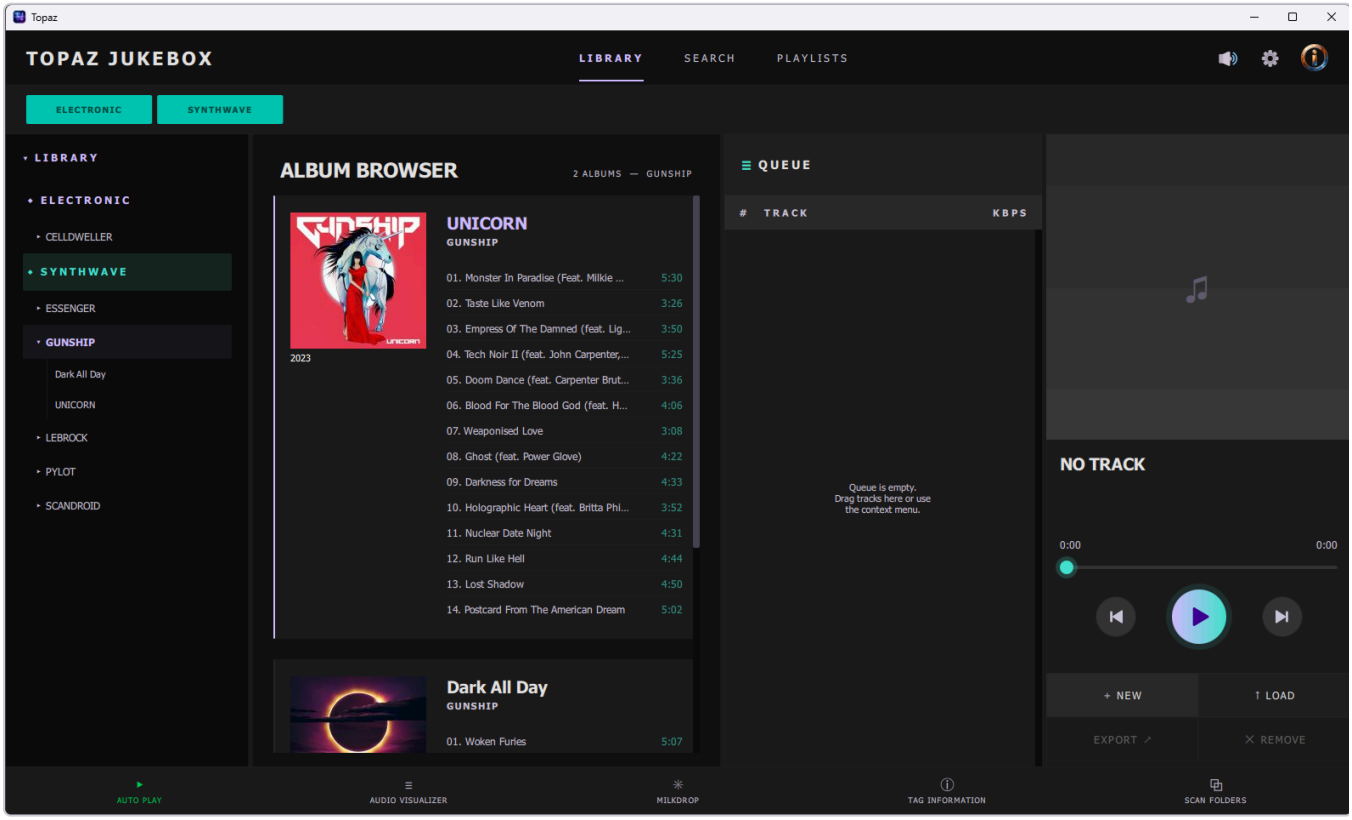


#	Area	What it is for
1	**LIBRARY · SEARCH · PLAYLISTS**	Switch between browsing, searching and playlists. The left two panels change; the queue and NowPlaying stay.
2	**Speaker · gear · ⓘ**	System volume and mute · Setup · About Topaz
3	**Genre bar**	One button per genre. Lit buttons are active.
4	**Library tree**	Genre → Artist → Album, for narrowing down what the Album Browser shows
5	**Album Browser**	Album cards with cover, year and all tracks
6	**Queue**	What plays next
7	**NowPlaying**	Cover, title, artist and genre of the current track. Click the cover for the Big Cover pane.
8	**Format · rating**	File format and bitrate (plus the loudness correction, when used) · your rating, 1–10 stars. For MP3s the bitrate says **VBR** (variable — the average is shown) or **CBR** (constant), for example `MP3 | VBR 182 KBPS`.
9	**Seek bar and transport**	Elapsed/total time, seek, Previous · Play/Pause · Next
10	**Playlist buttons**	+ NEW · LOAD · EXPORT · REMOVE
11	**Bottom bar**	AUTO PLAY · AUDIO VISUALIZER · MILKDROP · TAG INFORMATION · SCAN FOLDERS

Adjusting the layout

- Drag the **dividers** between the panels to make them wider or narrower. The Album Browser takes up whatever space is left.
- Every list has a **scrollbar thumb** on its right edge that you can drag with the mouse.
- Topaz remembers the panel widths, the window size and position, and the monitor it was on. The panel widths are remembered **separately** for the normal window and for full screen (**F11**): each mode gets back the sizes you last used in it. The first time you use full screen, the panels keep their current sizes until you adjust them.

Browsing your library

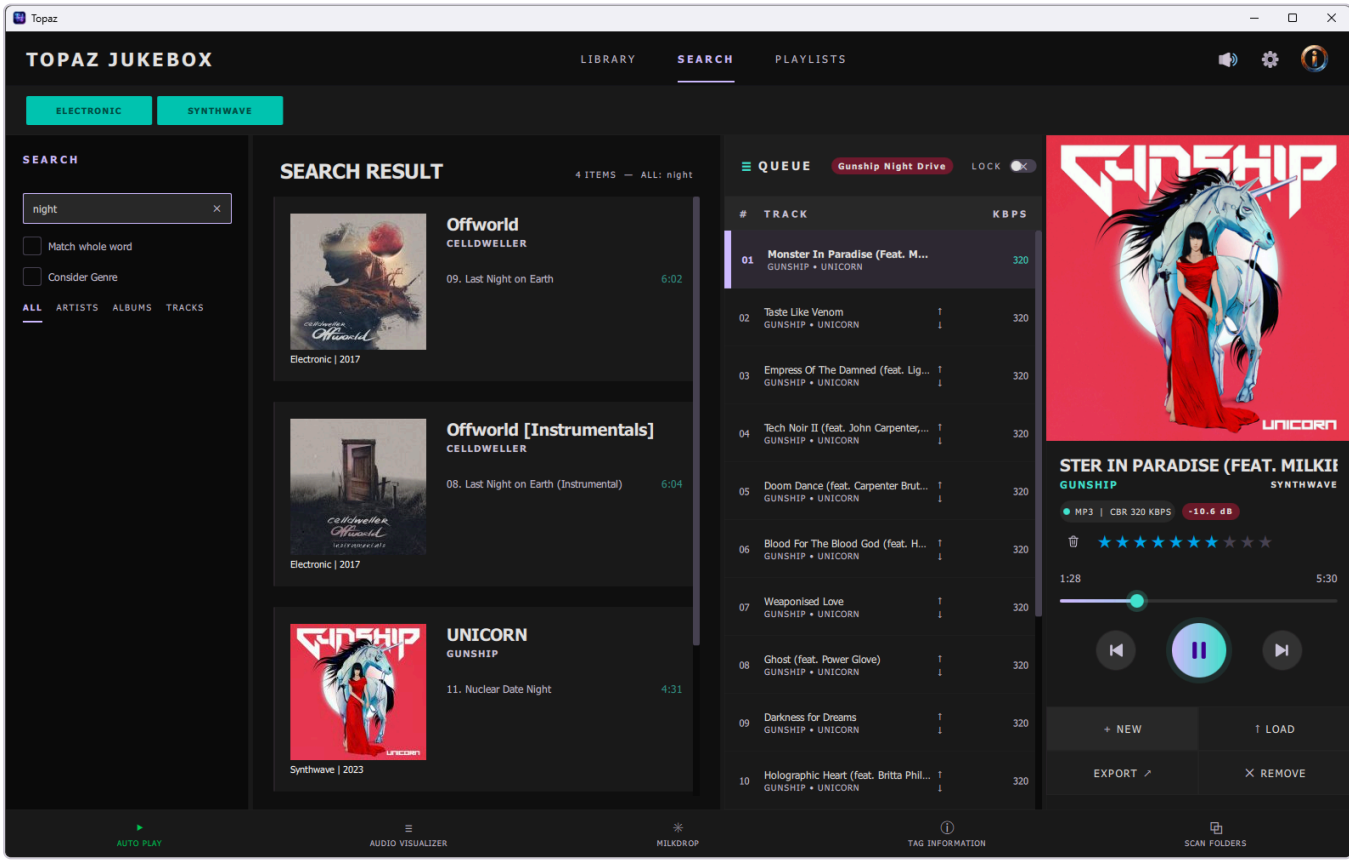


1. **Activate one or more genres** in the genre bar. The library tree lists their artists, and the Album Browser shows their albums.
2. **Narrow down** in the library tree:
    - click a **genre** to show only that genre,
    - click an **artist** to show only their albums (the artist expands to list the albums),
    - click an **album** to show just that album. Clicking the same entry again goes back one level.
3. Each **album card** shows the cover, the year, and all its tracks with their durations.

The order of the album cards can be chosen in Setup → MISC → **Album Browser & Search Result Sort Order**: *Artist → Year (newest first) → Album*, or *Artist → Album*.

Searching

Click **SEARCH** in the top bar and type in the search field.



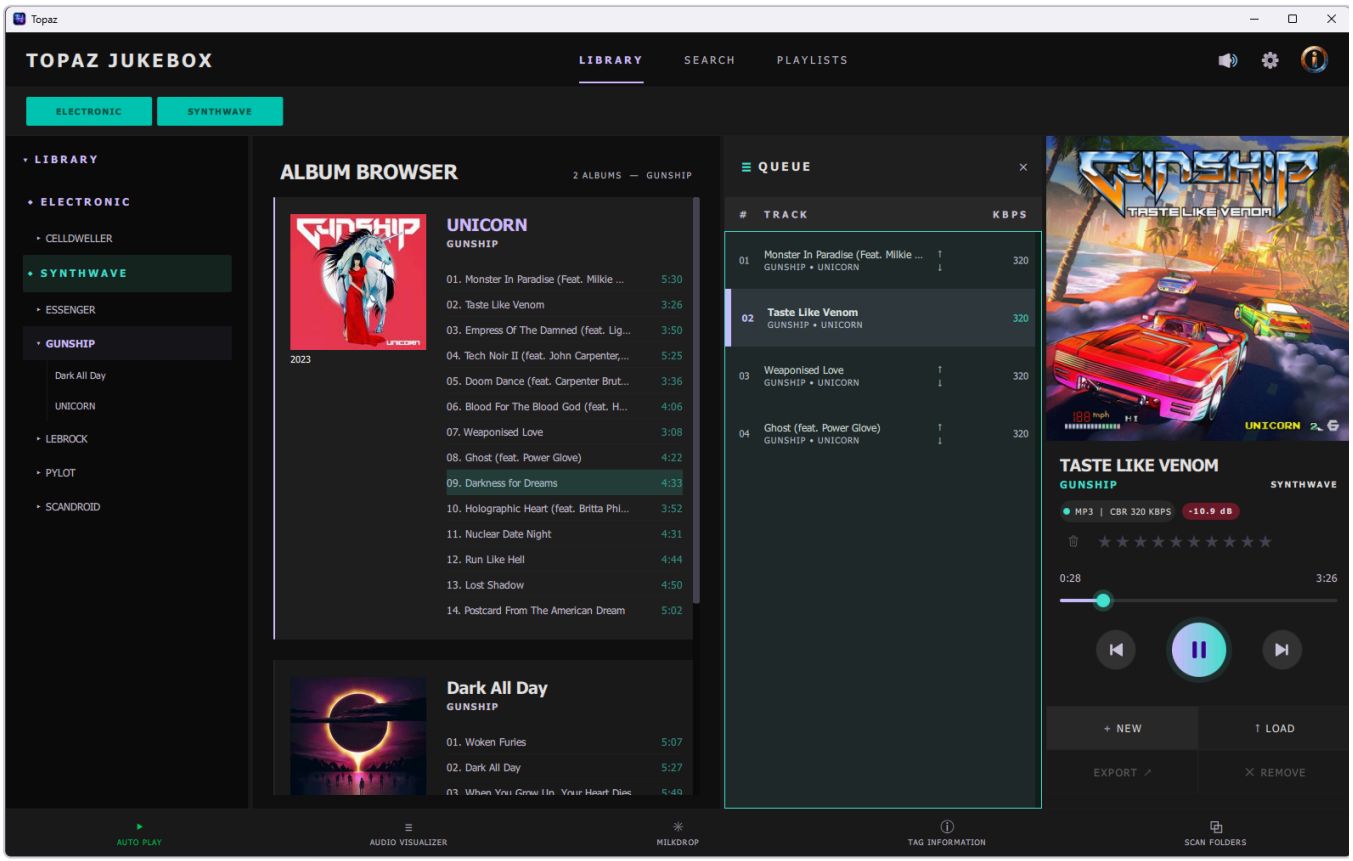
- Results appear as you type, as album cards — and can be added to the queue exactly like in the library.
- **ALL · ARTISTS · ALBUMS · TRACKS** choose what is searched. *ARTISTS* and *ALBUMS* show the whole artist or album; *TRACKS* shows only the matching tracks.
- **Match whole word** — "night" no longer matches "Nightmare".
- **Consider Genre** — search only the genres that are active in the genre bar. Without it, Topaz searches all genres that have a button.

The playback queue

The queue on the right side is the list of tracks Topaz plays, top to bottom.

Adding tracks

- **Double-click a track** in an album card → it is added to the end of the queue.
- **Drag a track** from an album card onto the queue. The queue lights up when you are over it.
- **Double-click an album's cover** (in the Album Browser) → the **whole album** is added.
- If nothing is playing, the first added track starts playing automatically.



Working with the queue

To ...	do this
play a track from the queue	click its row
move a track	use the ↑ / ↓ arrows on the row, or drag its number to a new position
remove a track	hover over the row and click its ✕
empty the whole queue	click ✕ in the queue header

The track playing is highlighted, and the queue scrolls along so that it always stays at the top.

Playback

Use the controls in NowPlaying — the large round **Play/Pause** button in the middle, with **Previous** and **Next** on either side (they light up turquoise when you point at them):

- **Play/Pause** — while you have paused, the button **blinks**.
- **Previous** — restarts the current track; pressed within the first 3 seconds it jumps to the previous track.
- **Next** — jumps to the next track.
- **Seek** — click or drag the seek bar. Its colour runs from purple at the start to turquoise at the end of the track.

Rating tracks

Click one of the **10 stars** to rate the current track, or click another star to change the rating. Ratings are stored separately from the library, so they survive any rescan. AUTO PLAY can use them (see AUTO PLAY).

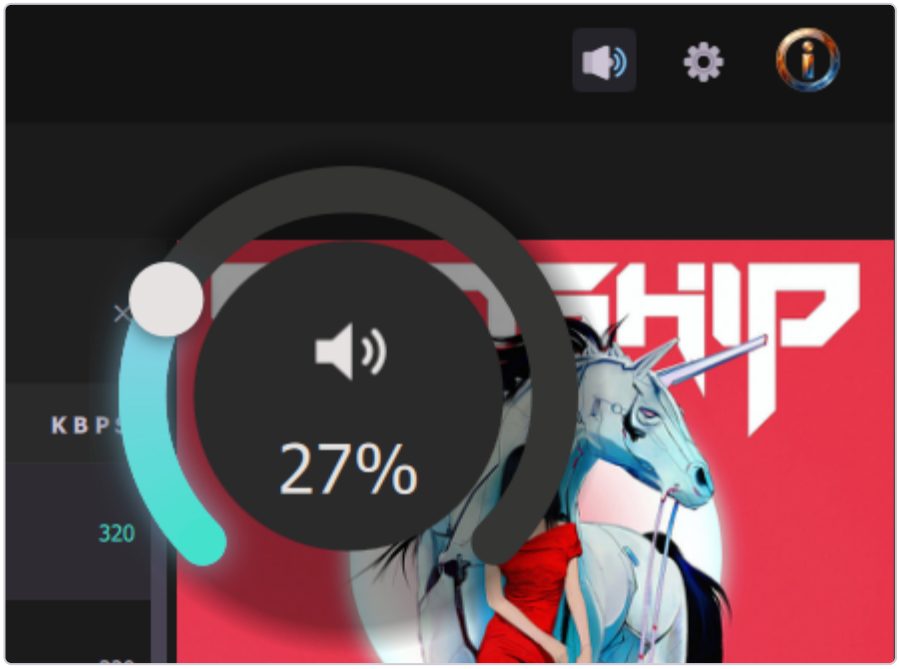
To remove a rating completely, click the **trash-bin icon** left of the stars; it asks for confirmation before deleting. (It is dimmed when the track has no rating.)

When NowPlaying is too narrow for the format badge and the stars side by side, the trash bin and the stars move to their own line just below the format badge.

Protecting your ratings: turn **off** *Modify the Rating for the Track currently playing* in Setup → MISC. The stars then still show each track's rating, but neither the stars nor the trash bin can be clicked — useful at a party, or when others use Topaz. It is on by default.

System volume and mute

The **speaker icon** in the top-right corner opens the volume knob. It controls your computer's **system volume** (not just Topaz).



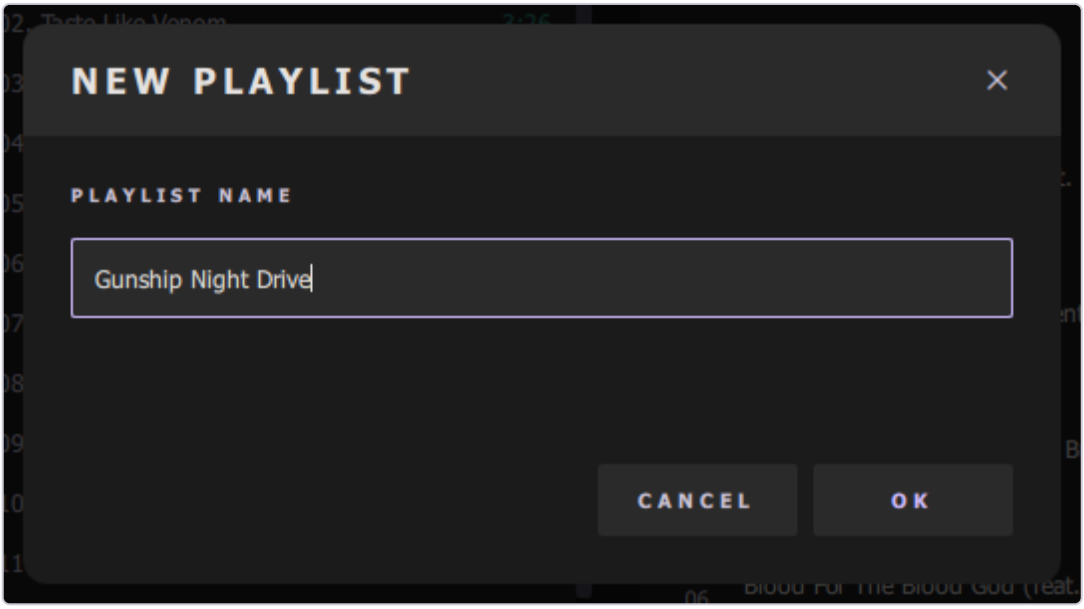
- **Drag** the ring, or turn the **mouse wheel** over the knob (2 % per notch).
- Click the **speaker symbol** in the middle to **mute** or unmute. Muting is the system mute, so it stays in sync with your keyboard's mute key.
- The knob closes by itself when the mouse moves away.

Playlists

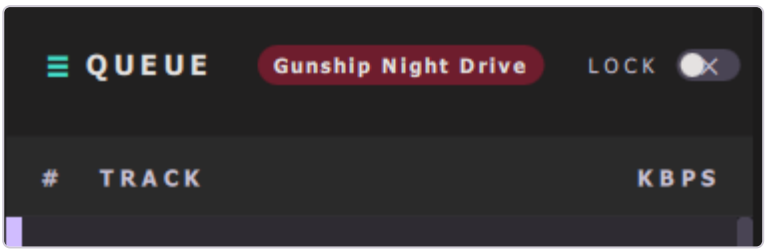
Playlists are saved as `.xml` files (the open XSPF format) in Topaz's `playlists` folder. They work across drive letters — a playlist still finds its tracks when your music drive gets a different letter.

Saving the queue as a playlist

1. Fill the queue.
2. Click **+ NEW** in NowPlaying, type a name and click **OK**.



The playlist is now **active**: its name appears in the queue header.



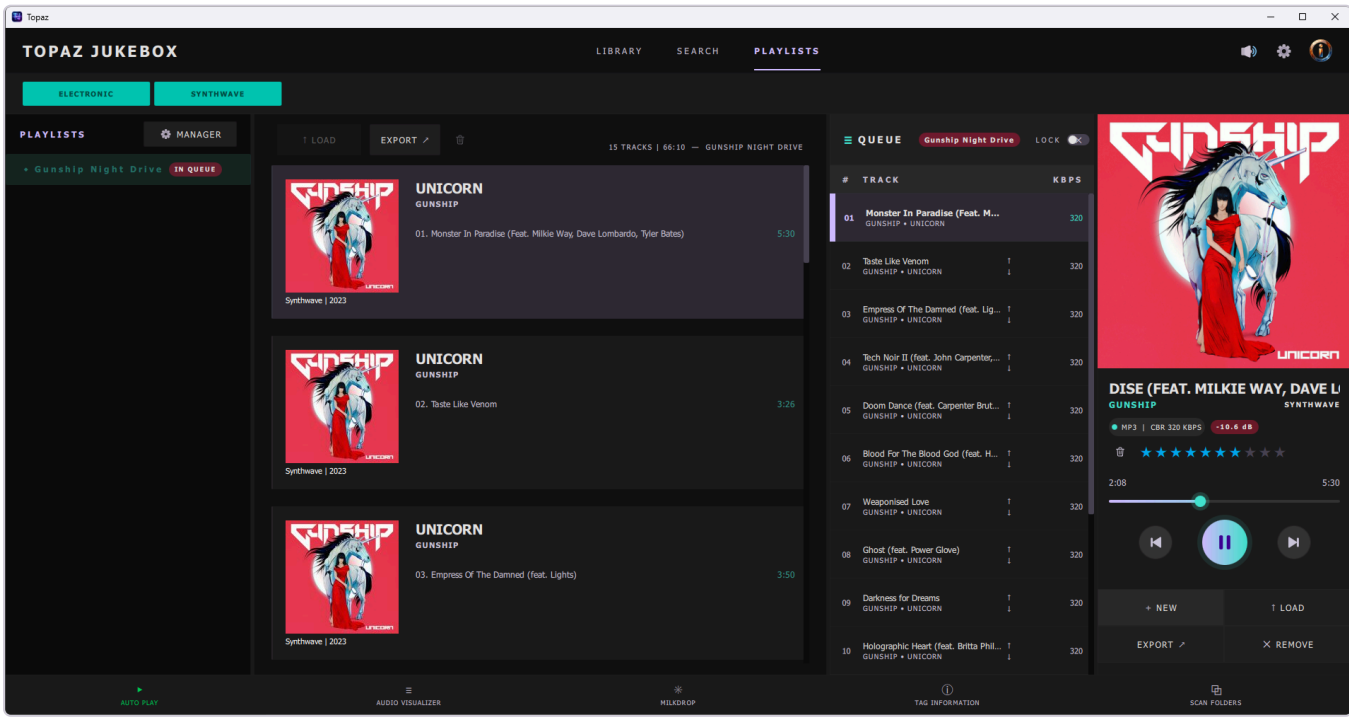
While a playlist is active, **changes to the queue are saved into the playlist file automatically**. If you want to rearrange or add tracks just for this listening session, switch on **LOCK** first: locked, the file stays as it is. Unlocking saves the current queue into the file.

Loading a playlist

- **LOAD** in NowPlaying opens a file picker in the playlists folder. A playlist from somewhere else (another computer, a USB stick) is first **copied into** Topaz's playlists folder, then loaded.
- Loading **replaces the queue**. If something is playing and Crossfade is on, the current track fades into the playlist's first track.
- **REMOVE** unloads the active playlist and empties the queue. The playlist file itself is kept.

The PLAYLISTS tab

Click **PLAYLISTS** in the top bar to browse all your playlists.



- Click a playlist on the left to **preview** it: one card per track, in playlist order, with the number of tracks and total playtime in the header.
- **LOAD** loads the previewed playlist into the queue.
- The playlist that is currently in the queue is marked **IN QUEUE**. When you select it, the preview follows the live queue, and the **track playing is highlighted** — just like in the queue.
- The **trash-bin icon** deletes the previewed playlist file (after a confirmation). It is not available for the playlist currently in the queue.
- Tracks can be added to the queue from the preview just like from the library (double-click or drag), except while previewing the playlist that is already in the queue.
- **MANAGER** is reserved for a future version.

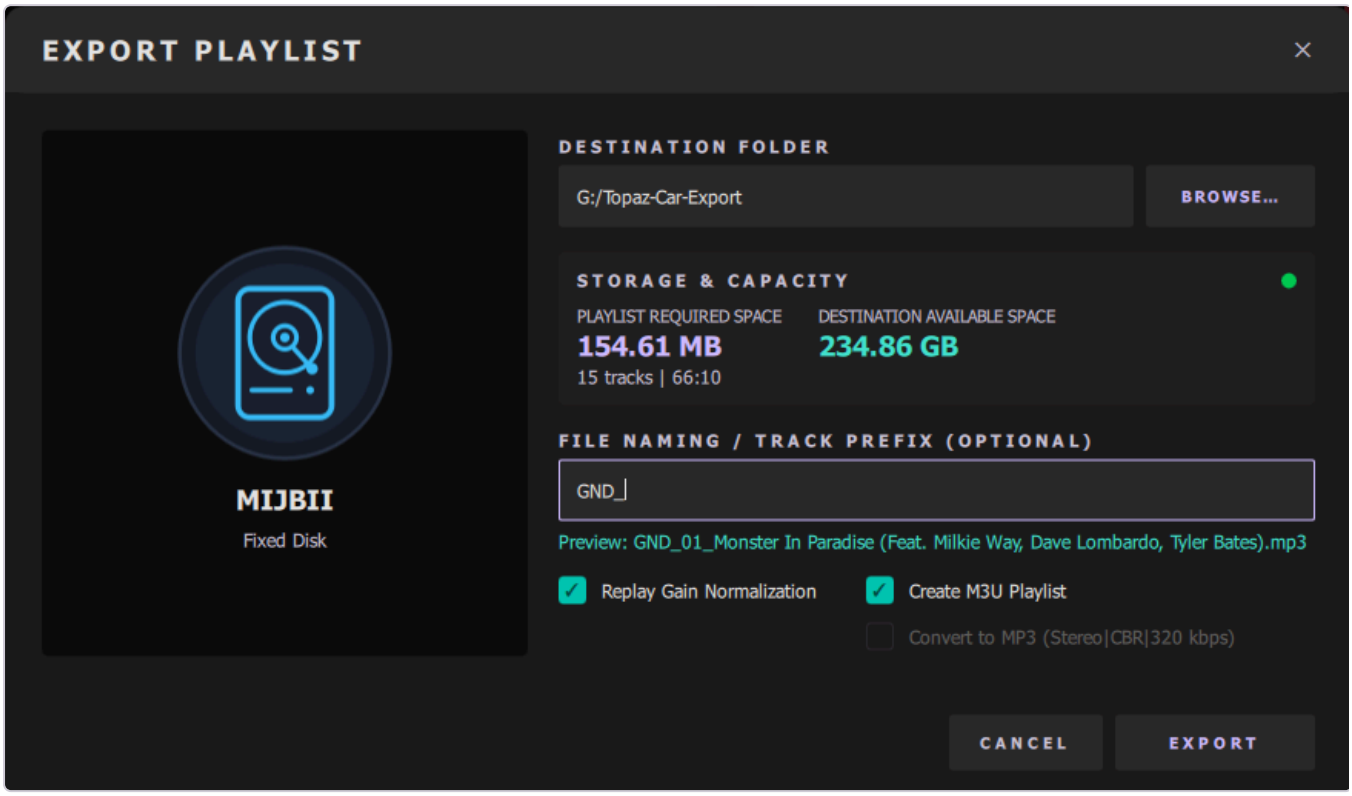
Missing tracks

- When a playlist refers to files that no longer exist, Topaz loads the rest and shows a **MISSING TRACKS** list with artist, album, title and the expected location.
- When the file of a queued track has disappeared by the time it is due to play, Topaz **stops** cleanly instead of hanging, shows a **MISSING TRACK** message, and rescans just that folder so the library is up to date again. A running AUTO PLAY session stops as well.

Exporting a playlist

Export copies all tracks of a playlist to another place — typically a **USB stick for the car** — with neatly numbered file names.

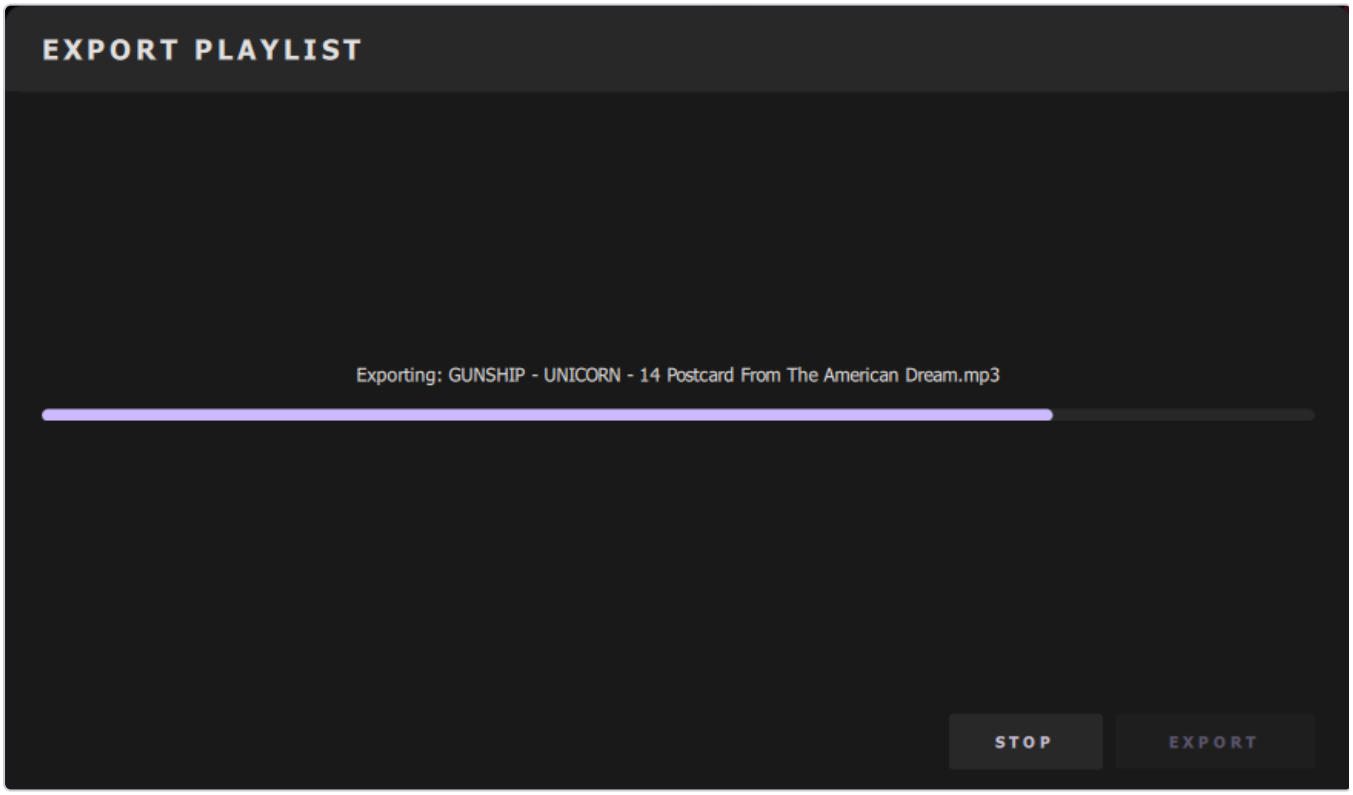
Start it with **EXPORT** in NowPlaying (exports the playlist in the queue) or **EXPORT** in the PLAYLISTS tab (exports the previewed playlist).



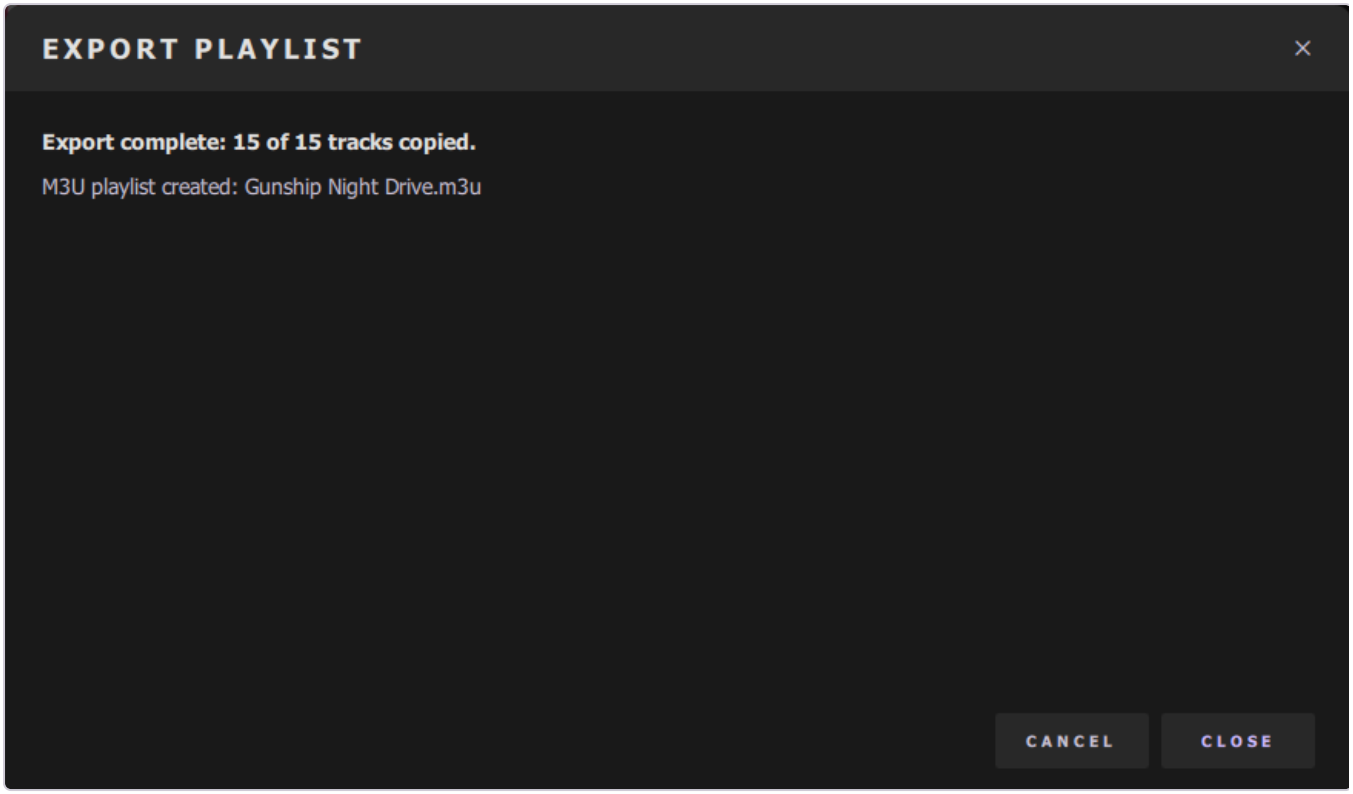
1. **BROWSE...** to choose the destination folder. Topaz checks it right away:
   - the icon shows whether it is a USB stick or a fixed disk,
   - **PLAYLIST REQUIRED SPACE** versus **DESTINATION AVAILABLE SPACE** — the dot turns green when everything fits and the destination is writable, red otherwise (with the reason).
2. Optional: a **track prefix** for the file names. The preview shows the result, for example `GND_01_Monster In Paradise.mp3`. Files are always numbered in playlist order.
3. Optional: **Replay Gain Normalization** — writes a Replay Gain tag into each **copy**, so players that support Replay Gain play all tracks at the same loudness. It uses the same reference value and Trim as Auto Loudness Correction (Audiophile) — including the **Always measure** setting (see Where the loudness value comes from), even while Auto Loudness Correction itself is switched off. Available only when BASS is the active playback engine.
4. Optional: **Create M3U Playlist** (right of Replay Gain) — also writes a playlist file named after the playlist, for example `Road Trip.m3u`, into the destination folder. It lists the exported tracks in order. Why: some car stereos play the numbered files of a folder in order, others read a playlist file — with both on the stick, either kind of car stereo works.
5. Optional: **Convert to MP3 (Stereo|CBR|320 kbps)** (below Create M3U Playlist) — every FLAC or Opus track is converted to an MP3 (44.1 kHz, stereo, constant 320 kbps) while it is copied; MP3 tracks are copied as they are. Tags and cover art are carried over. This needs **ffmpeg** (see Optional extras). The

checkbox is dimmed when the playlist contains no FLAC/Opus tracks or ffmpeg isn't found — its tooltip says which. With it ticked, the required space is recalculated for the MP3 sizes. The M3U playlist then lists the new MP3 file names.

6. Click **EXPORT**.



The progress bar shows how far the export is; **STOP** cancels it. At the end Topaz reports how many tracks were copied — and, if any were converted, how many were converted to MP3, and whether the M3U playlist was created. Any track that failed is listed.

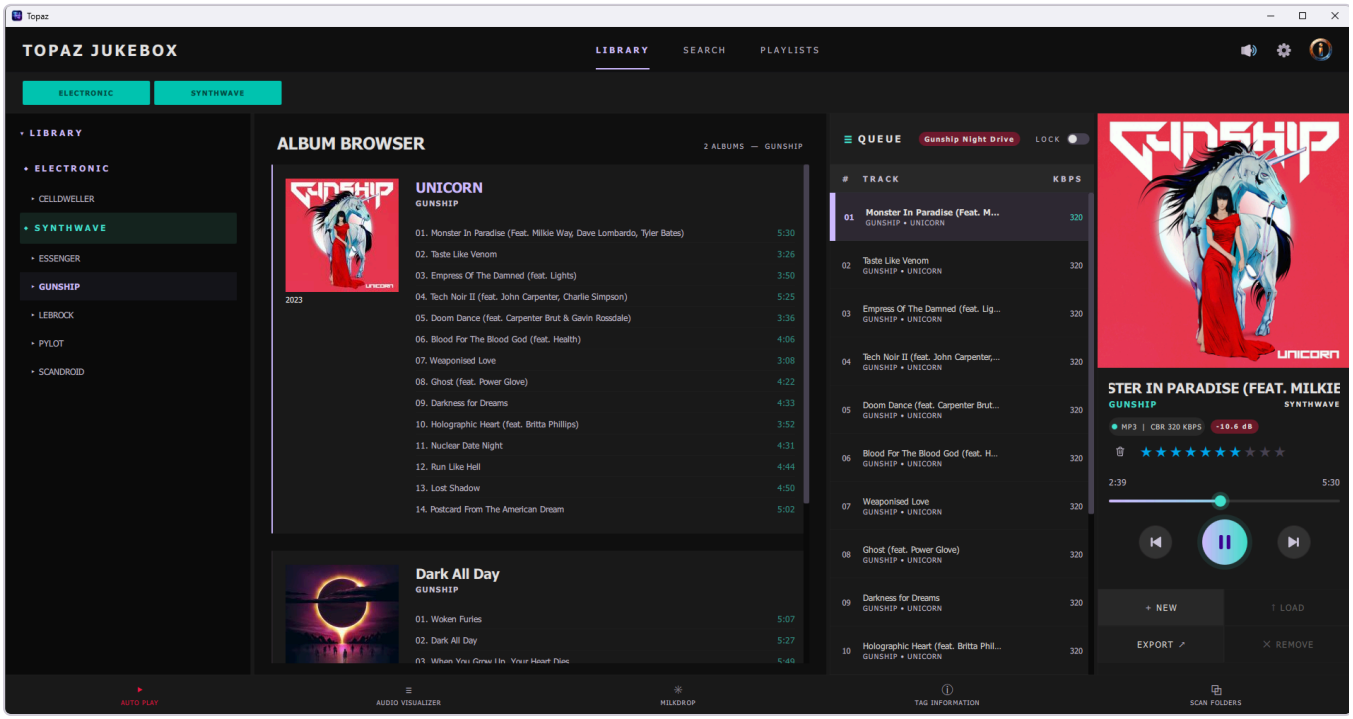


Your original files are never touched — Replay Gain tags and MP3 conversion only ever apply to the exported copies.

AUTO PLAY

AUTO PLAY turns Topaz into a real jukebox: it keeps adding randomly chosen tracks from your library, so the music never stops.

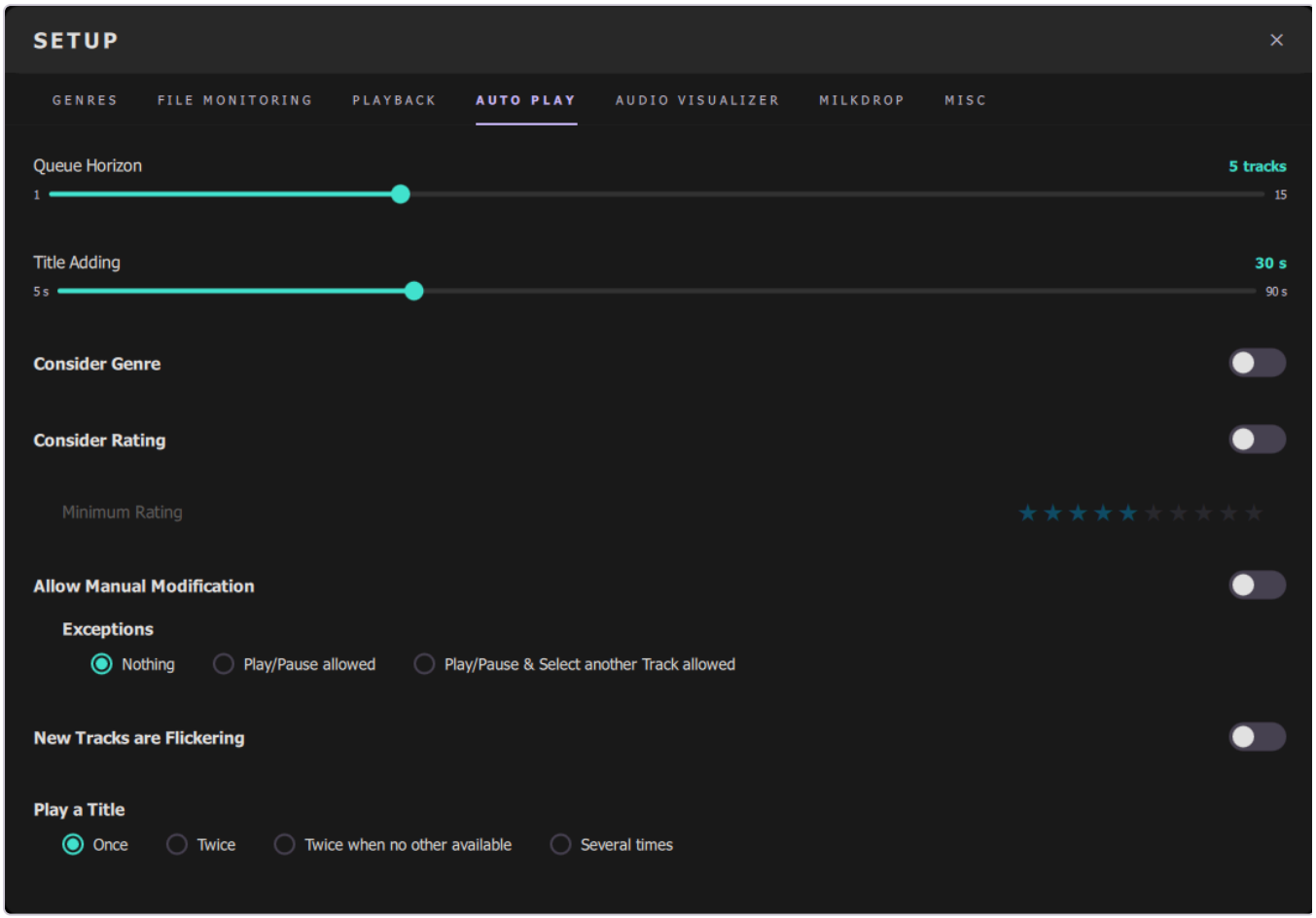
- Click **AUTO PLAY** in the bottom bar to start it. The button turns **red** while it runs; click it again to stop.
- If the queue is empty, the first track starts immediately. Otherwise AUTO PLAY waits and then tops up the queue one track at a time.
- When no suitable track is left (for example every track has been played once), AUTO PLAY stops by itself. On Windows you get a desktop notification when AUTO PLAY starts, stops or runs out of tracks.



During a session the queue belongs to AUTO PLAY: it can't be cleared, LOAD and REMOVE are disabled, and — unless you allow it — tracks can't be added, removed or moved by hand.

AUTO PLAY settings

These are on the **AUTO PLAY** tab of the Setup dialog.

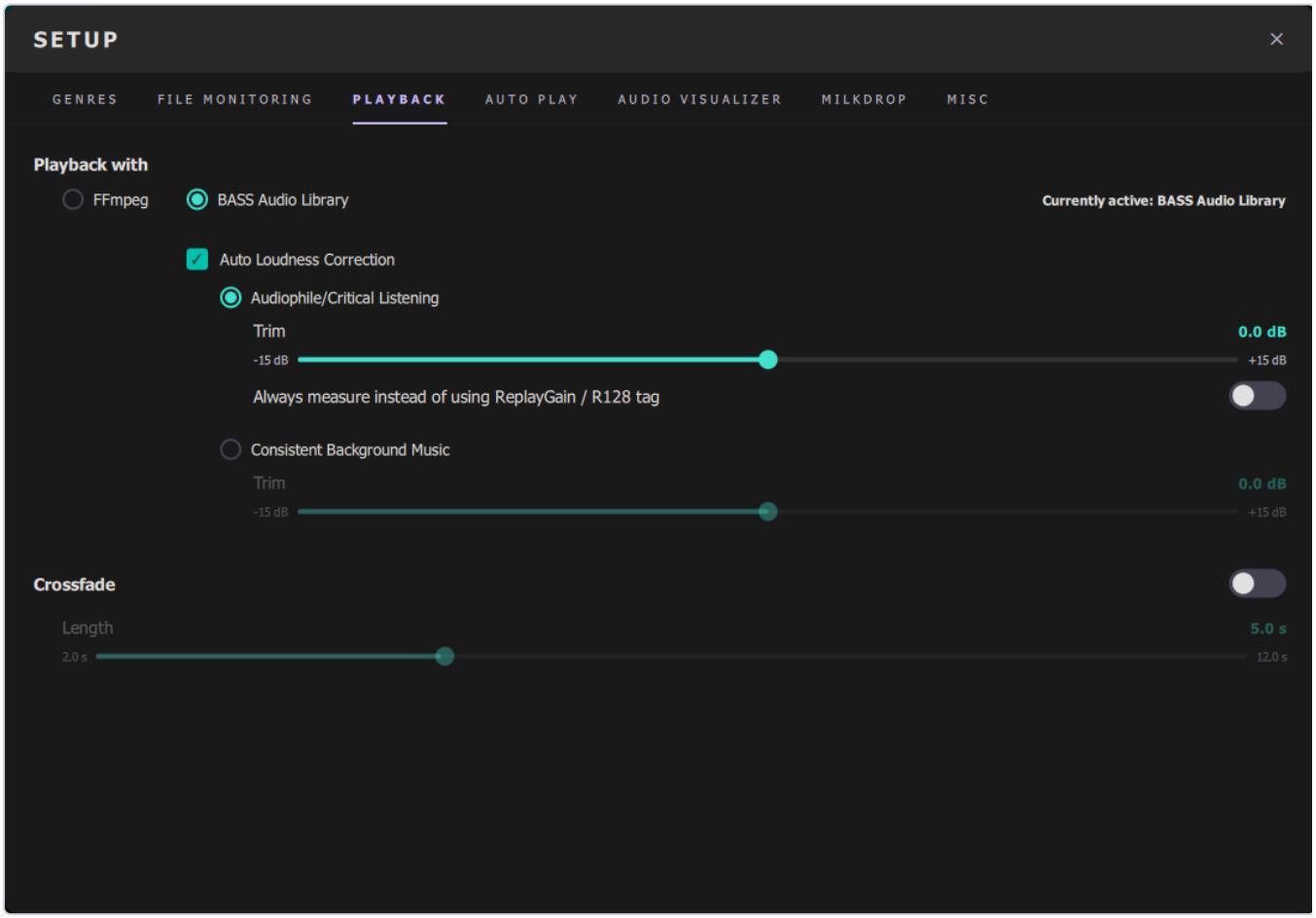


Setting	Meaning
Queue Horizon (1–15 tracks)	How many tracks AUTO PLAY keeps queued ahead of the one playing
Title Adding (5–90 s)	How often AUTO PLAY checks the queue and adds a track if needed
Consider Genre	Only pick tracks from the genres active in the genre bar
Consider Rating + **Minimum Rating**	Only pick tracks rated at least this many stars (unrated tracks are skipped)
Allow Manual Modification	Lets you add, remove and move tracks during a session
Exceptions	Without manual modification: *Nothing* · *Play/Pause allowed* · *Play/Pause & Select another Track allowed*
New Tracks are Flickering	Newly added tracks briefly flash in the queue
Play a Title	*Once* · *Twice* · *Twice when no other available* · *Several times* — how often a track may be picked in one session

The AUTO PLAY button can only be started when its requirements can be met — for example with Consider Genre on, at least one genre must be active.

Sound settings

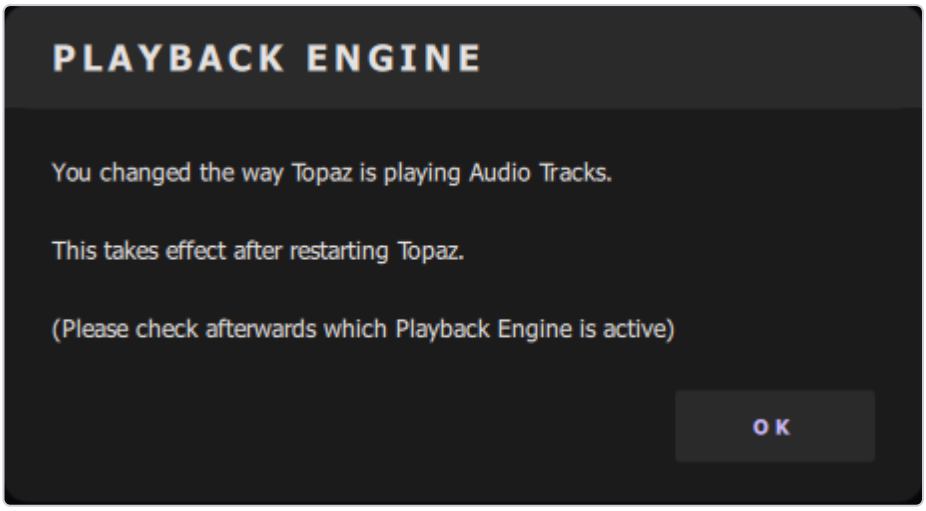
All of these are on the **PLAYBACK** tab of the Setup dialog.



Playback engine

Engine	
FFmpeg	Built in, needs nothing. The default.
BASS Audio Library	Needs the BASS files (see Optional extras). Required for Auto Loudness Correction and Replay Gain export.

Switching the engine takes effect **after restarting Topaz**; Topaz reminds you. "Currently active" shows the engine that is really running.



Crossfade

Turn on **Crossfade** and choose the **Length** (2–12 seconds): the next track fades in while the current one fades out. It also applies when you load a different playlist while music is playing. Tracks that are too short for the chosen length simply switch without a fade.

Auto Loudness Correction (BASS only)

Tracks are mastered at very different loudness. Auto Loudness Correction evens this out — **without ever changing a file**.

- **Audiophile/Critical Listening** — one fixed correction per track, based on its measured loudness (or an existing ReplayGain / R128 tag, unless **Always measure** is on — see below). The dynamics stay untouched. The correction is determined once and remembered; NowPlaying shows the value applied, for example `-10.9 dB`.
- **Consistent Background Music** — a gentle compressor that keeps everything at a similar level, for background listening. Needs BASS_FX.
- **Trim** (each strategy has its own, −15 to +15 dB in 0.1 dB steps) — your own adjustment on top. The automatic Audiophile level is fairly quiet by design (it follows the Replay Gain standard); raise Trim if you want it louder. Unlike the automatic correction, a large positive Trim can clip on very loud peaks.
- **Always measure instead of using ReplayGain / R128 tag** (switch below the Audiophile Trim, off by default) — see the next section.

Where the loudness value comes from

With *Audiophile/Critical Listening*, Topaz needs one loudness value per track. The target is the ReplayGain 2.0 reference level of **−18 LUFS** (measured the EBU R128 way).

Always measure OFF (the default) — Topaz uses the first of these that applies:

1. **A value it worked out before** and remembered — as long as the file has not changed.
2. **A ReplayGain / R128 tag already in the file** — the *track* gain (never the album gain). An Opus file's R128 tag is converted to the same −18 LUFS target.
3. **Its own measurement** of the track — then remembered for next time.

Always measure ON — the tags in your files are ignored, and every track is measured by Topaz itself. Why you might want that: tags written by other programs may use the older ReplayGain 1.0 method, may hold the album gain instead of the track gain, or may be out of date after a remaster or re-encode. Then the levels across your library don't match. With Always measure on, every track is on **one consistent scale**. Measuring is fast — a few tenths of a second per track — but the first pass over a large library takes a while; it runs in the background, starting with the track playing and the next one.

Good to know:

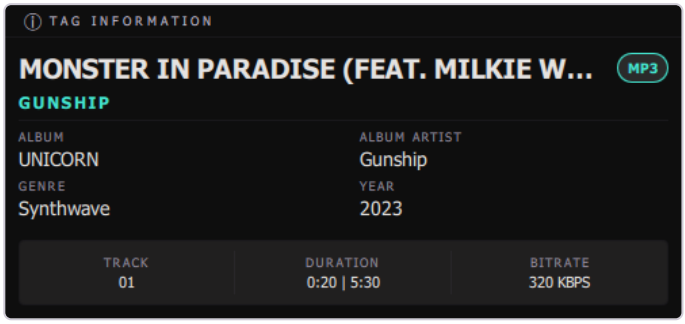
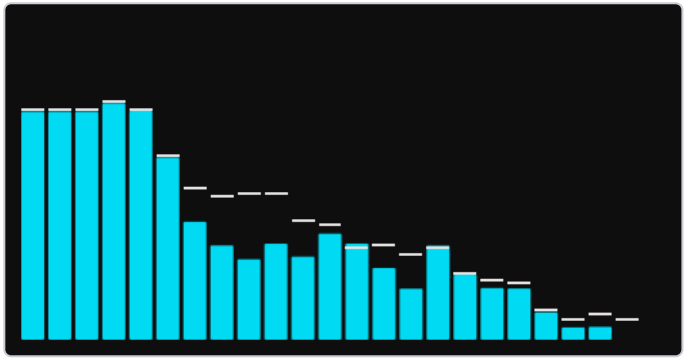
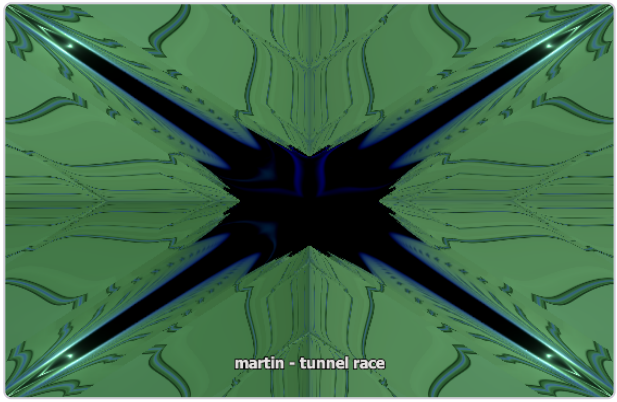
- The switch has an effect only with the **BASS Audio Library**, Auto Loudness Correction on and *Audiophile/Critical Listening* selected; otherwise it is greyed out. **Trim** is still added on top.
- **Switching it on:** values that came from tags are measured again automatically; the track playing adjusts smoothly within a moment. There is nothing to delete.
- **Switching it off again does not bring the tag values back:** tracks that were measured keep their measured value. To start completely from scratch, close Topaz and delete `Topaz.volumeNormalization.json` in Topaz's data folder (see Where Topaz keeps its data).
- **Export:** *Replay Gain Normalization* in the Export dialog follows this switch too — even while Auto Loudness Correction is off. With it on, an exported copy gets Topaz's measured value (plus Trim), not the value from the original file's tag.
- Your audio files are never changed — all values live in `Topaz.volumeNormalization.json`.

Hi-Res badge

If you place an image named `Hi-Res_Audio.svg` next to `Topaz.exe`, Topaz shows it in the top bar while a FLAC track is playing. The logo is a trademark and therefore not included.

Detachable panes and full screen

Four extra windows ("panes") can float anywhere — on the same screen or a second monitor — for example as a "now playing" display at a party.

Pane	Opens with	
Big Cover	a click on the cover in NowPlaying	
Tag Information	**TAG INFORMATION** in the bottom bar	
Audio Visualizer	**AUDIO VISUALIZER** in the bottom bar	
Milkdrop	**MILKDROP** in the bottom bar	

Working with panes:

- **Move** a pane by dragging it anywhere; **resize** it at its edges (the Big Cover keeps its square shape).
- **Fine-tune** a pane's position with the keyboard: click the pane — a thin **turquoise frame** shows it is selected — then the **arrow keys** move it **1 pixel** at a time, with **Shift** 10 pixels; holding a key keeps it moving. Only the selected pane moves, even with several open. **Esc** or **Enter** ends fine-tuning, and so does clicking somewhere else or 4 seconds without a key press. (Not while Milkdrop is in full screen with F10.)
- **Right-click** a pane to close it (or click its button in the bottom bar again).
- **Double-click** the Big Cover or Milkdrop pane to move it across its screen: centered → right edge → left edge → back where it was.
- **Double-click** the Tag Information pane to stretch it across the full width of its screen, and again to restore it. Its text grows and shrinks with the pane. Its **DURATION** field shows the **time remaining** and the total length (for example `0:20 | 5:30`).
- **F10** switches the Milkdrop pane to full screen on the monitor it is on, and back.
- Topaz remembers where each pane was, including on which monitor.

The **Audio Visualizer** (bars) and **Milkdrop** are configured on their own Setup tabs — see the Setup reference. Milkdrop needs **preset files** (`.milk`, freely available on the internet); add the folder holding them on the MILKDROP tab. Milkdrop also needs a graphics driver with OpenGL 3.3 or newer.

Full screen

- **F11** switches the main window between full screen and a normal window. Each mode remembers its own panel widths.
- **Start Topaz in Full Screen** (Setup → MISC) starts Topaz that way, on the monitor it was last on.
- In full screen the **mouse pointer hides** after 5 seconds without movement and comes back as soon as you move the mouse.
- **Kiosk mode:** while the main window is full screen, open panes stay **on top**, even over the taskbar — ideal for a dedicated jukebox display.
- Windows hides desktop notifications (such as AUTO PLAY's) while an app is in full screen. This is Windows' Focus Assist, which you can change in the Windows settings.

Setup reference

Every option of the Setup dialog in one place. All changes are saved immediately.

GENRES

See Step 2: add your genres.

Control	Meaning
Genre cells (6 × 8)	Your genres. Drag a cell to change the order of the genre buttons.
Checkbox in a cell	Whether the genre gets a button in the genre bar (up to 40)
ADD	Adds the genre typed in the field (or press **Enter**)
SCAN FOLDERS	Opens FOUND GENRES: the genres found in your active music folders, to pick from. Not the same as SCAN FOLDERS in the main window's bottom bar, which scans the library.
DELETE SELECTED · **DELETE ALL**	Remove the selected genre · all genres

FILE MONITORING

See Step 1: add your music folders.

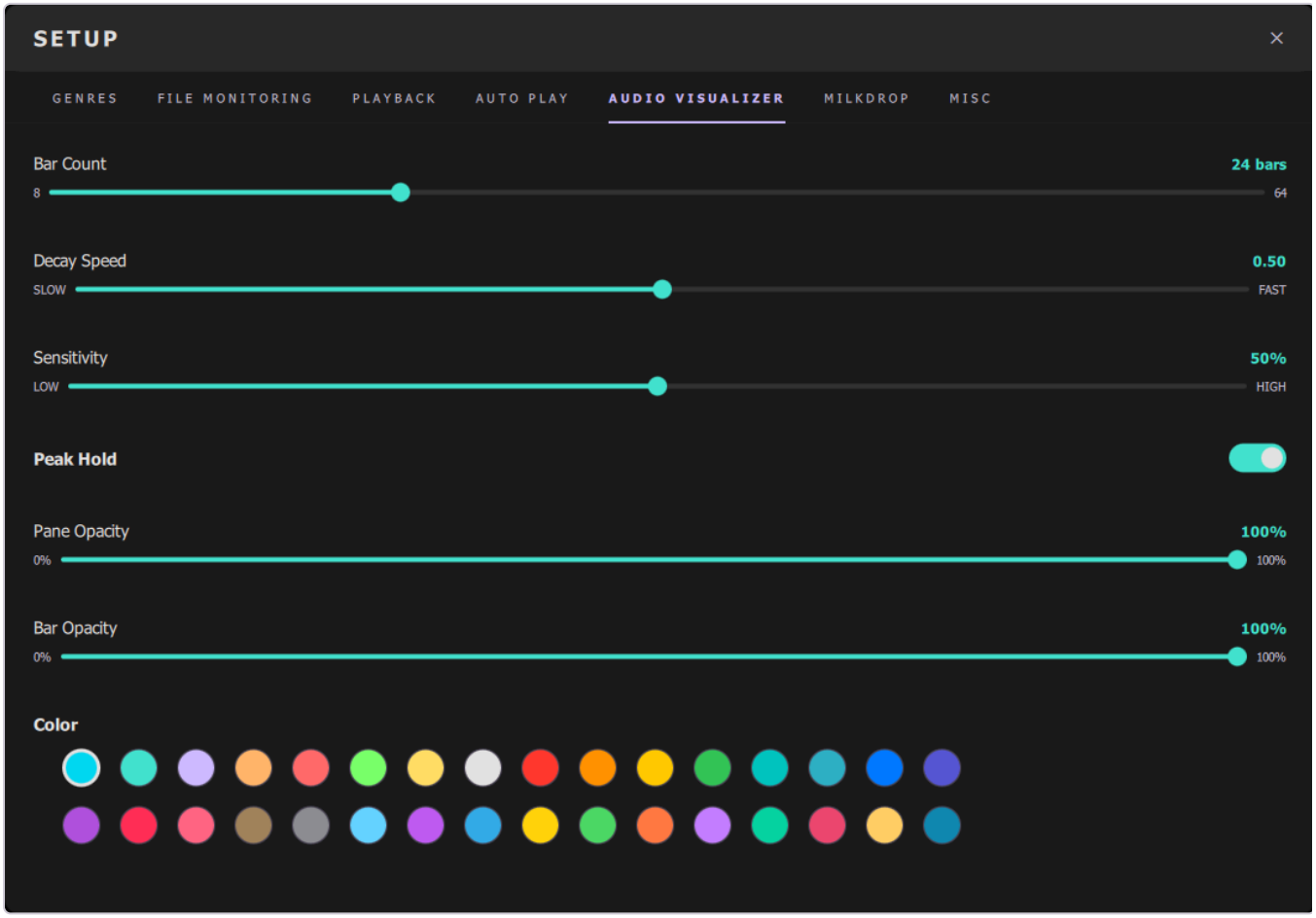
PLAYBACK

See Sound settings.

AUTO PLAY

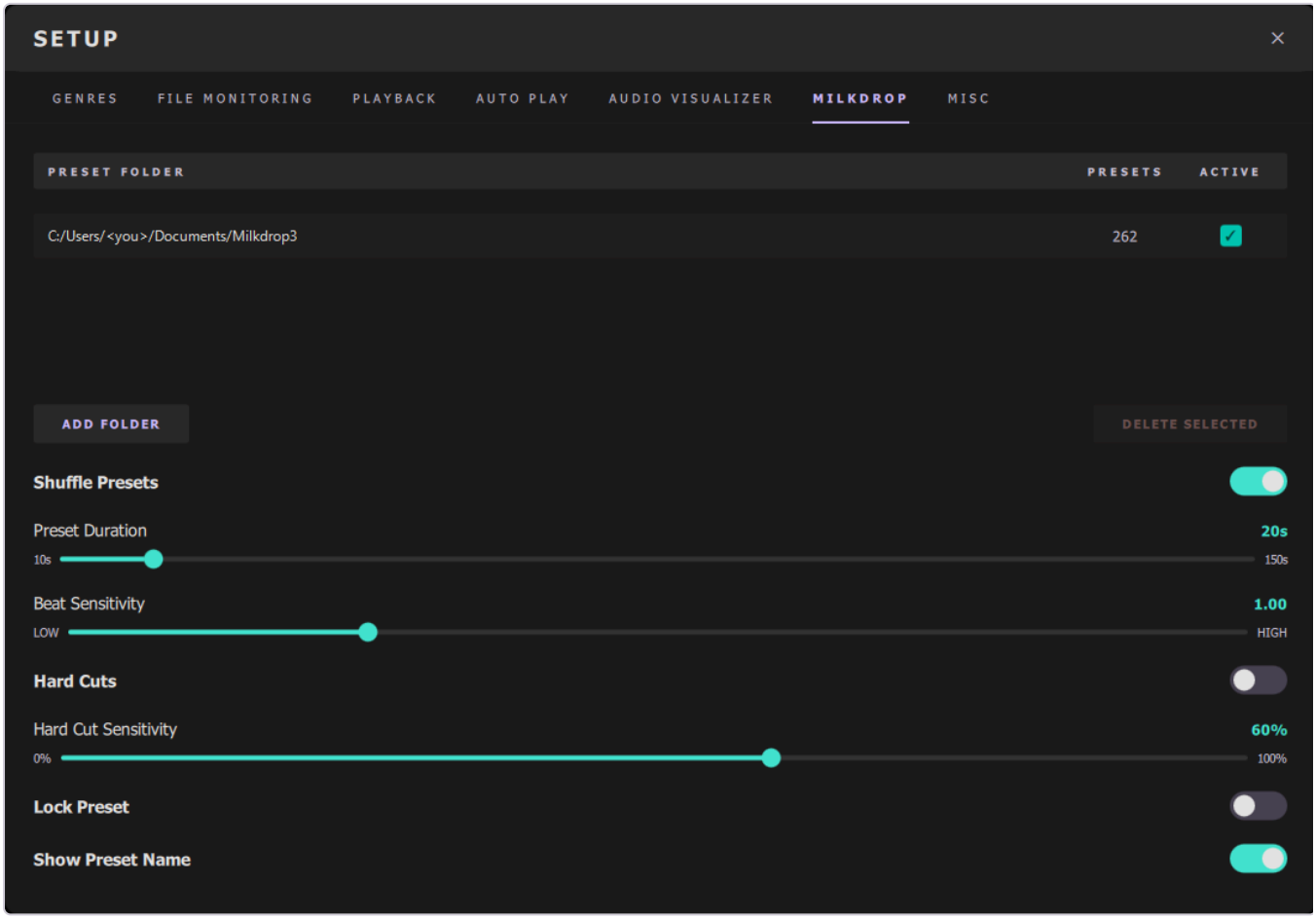
See AUTO PLAY settings.

AUDIO VISUALIZER



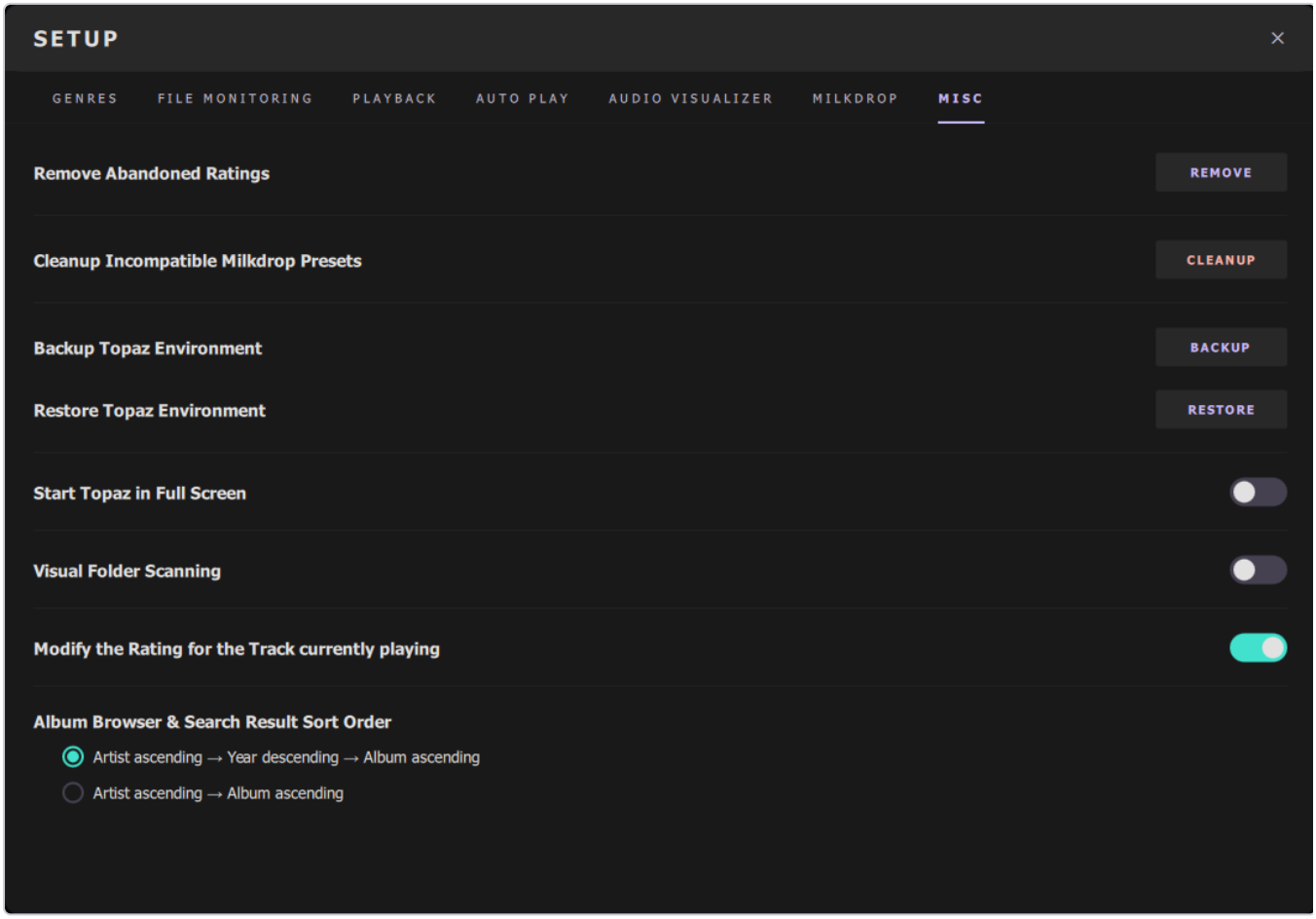
Setting	Meaning
Bar Count	Number of bars (8–64)
Decay Speed	How fast the bars fall back
Sensitivity	How strongly the bars react
Peak Hold	Small markers that show each bar's recent peak
Pane Opacity · **Bar Opacity**	Transparency of the pane background and of the bars — at low pane opacity the bars float over your desktop
Color	Color of the bars

MILKDROP



Setting	Meaning
Preset folders	Folders with `.milk` preset files; **ADD FOLDER** / **DELETE SELECTED**, **ACTIVE** per folder. **PRESETS** shows how many were found.
Shuffle Presets	Random preset order instead of a fixed one
Preset Duration	How long each preset is shown (10–150 s)
Beat Sensitivity	How strongly the visuals react to the beat
Hard Cuts · Hard Cut Sensitivity	Allow abrupt preset changes on strong beats, and how easily they happen
Lock Preset	Stay on the current preset
Show Preset Name	Briefly fade in the preset's name at the bottom when it changes

MISC

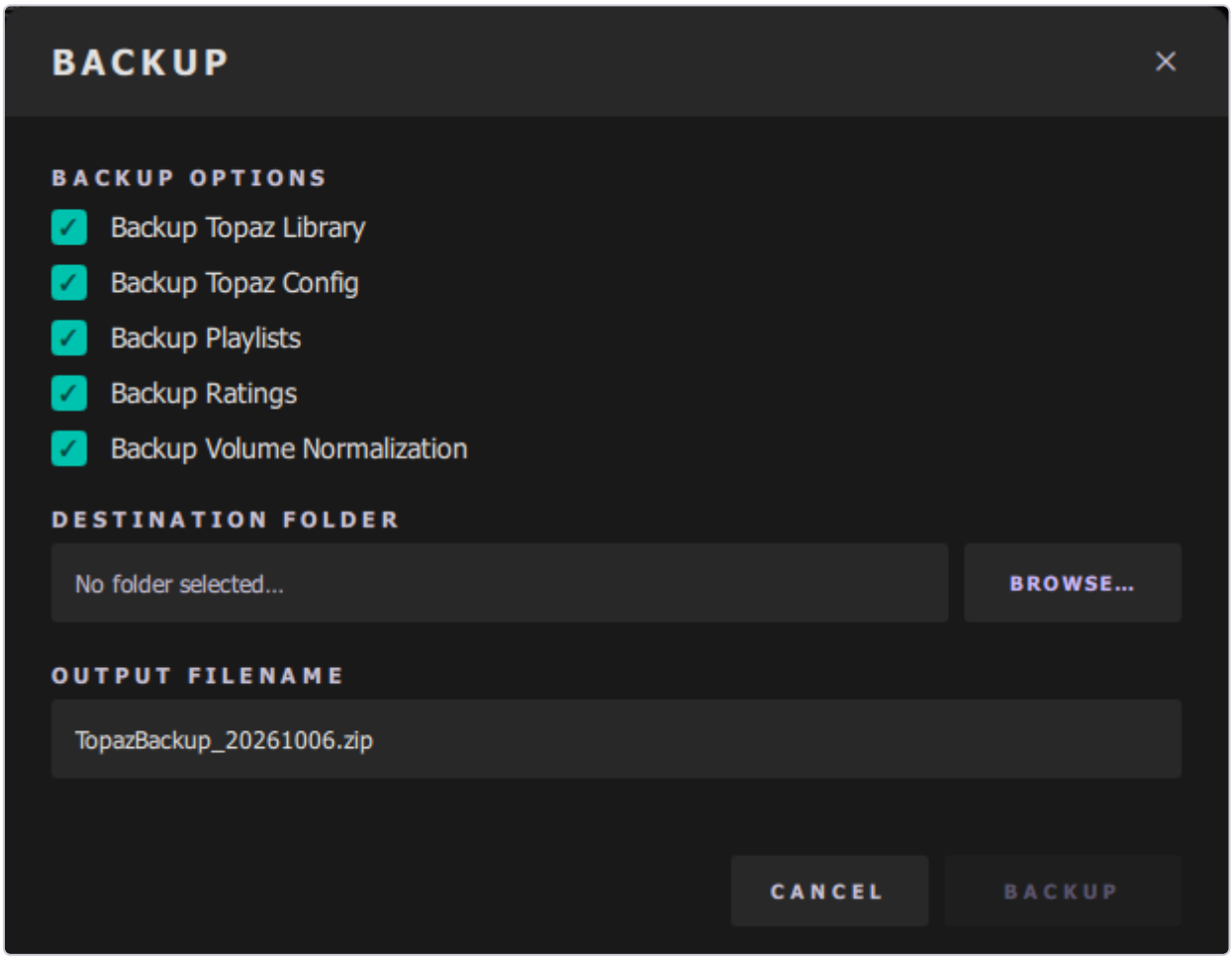


Setting	Meaning
Remove Abandoned Ratings	Deletes ratings of tracks that are no longer in your library
Cleanup Incompatible Milkdrop Presets	Finds and deletes preset files that don't work in Topaz
Backup Topaz Environment · **Restore Topaz Environment**	See Maintenance and backup
Start Topaz in Full Screen	Takes effect on the next start
Visual Folder Scanning	Shows the SCAN FOLDERS progress window during scans
Modify the Rating for the Track currently playing	On (default): the rating of the playing track can be set, changed (stars) and deleted (trash bin). Off: the rating is shown but locked. See Rating tracks.
Album Browser & Search Result Sort Order	*Artist → Year (newest first) → Album*, or *Artist → Album*

Maintenance and backup

Backup

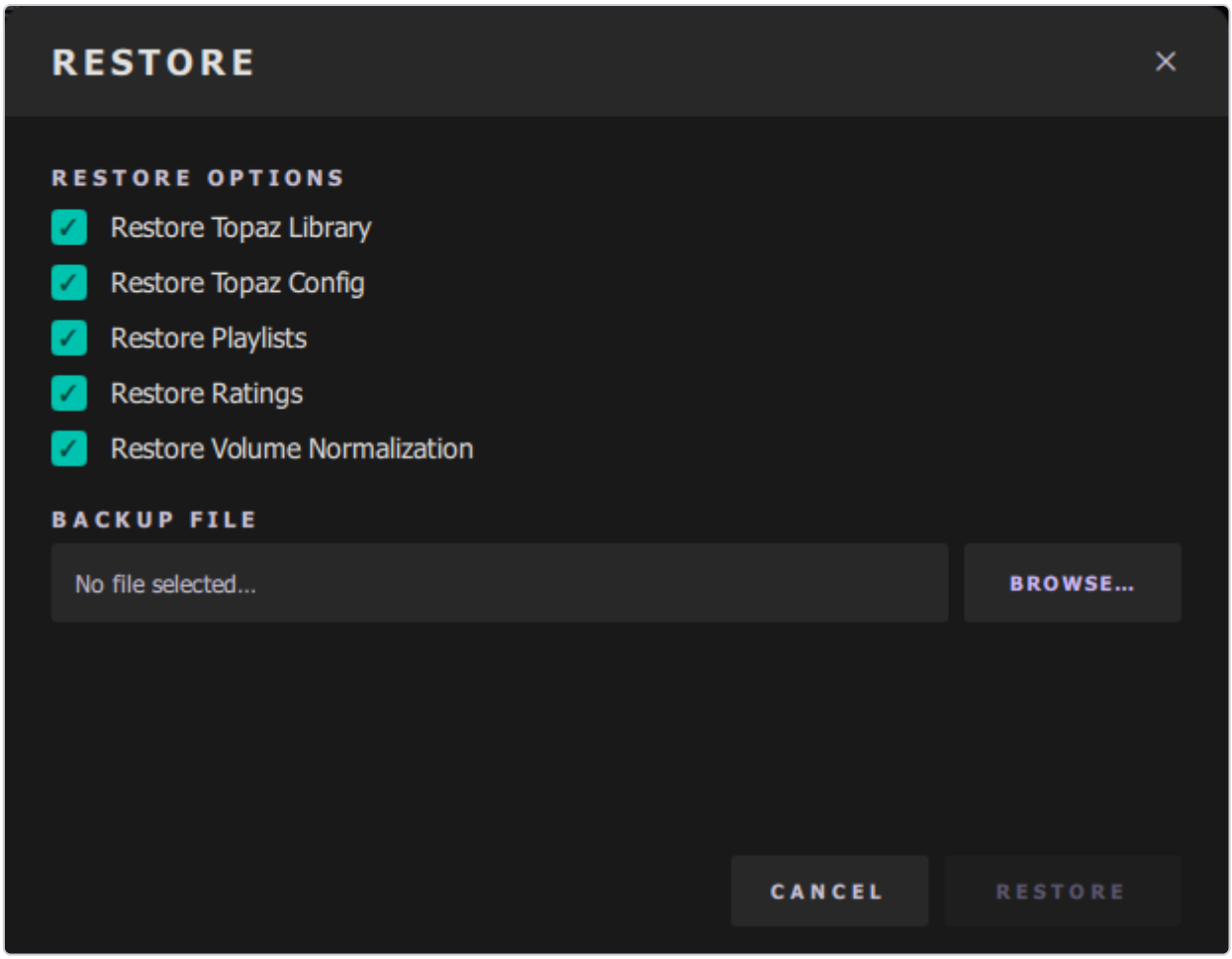
Setup → MISC → **BACKUP** saves your Topaz environment into a single `.zip` file.



Choose what to include — **Library**, **Config**, **Playlists**, **Ratings**, **Volume Normalization** — a destination folder and a file name (it defaults to today's date), then click **BACKUP**.

Restore

Setup → MISC → **RESTORE** brings a backup back.



Choose the backup file and which parts to restore, then click **RESTORE**. Topaz asks for confirmation first, because restoring **replaces** the current data of the chosen parts. The restored data is active immediately — no restart needed.

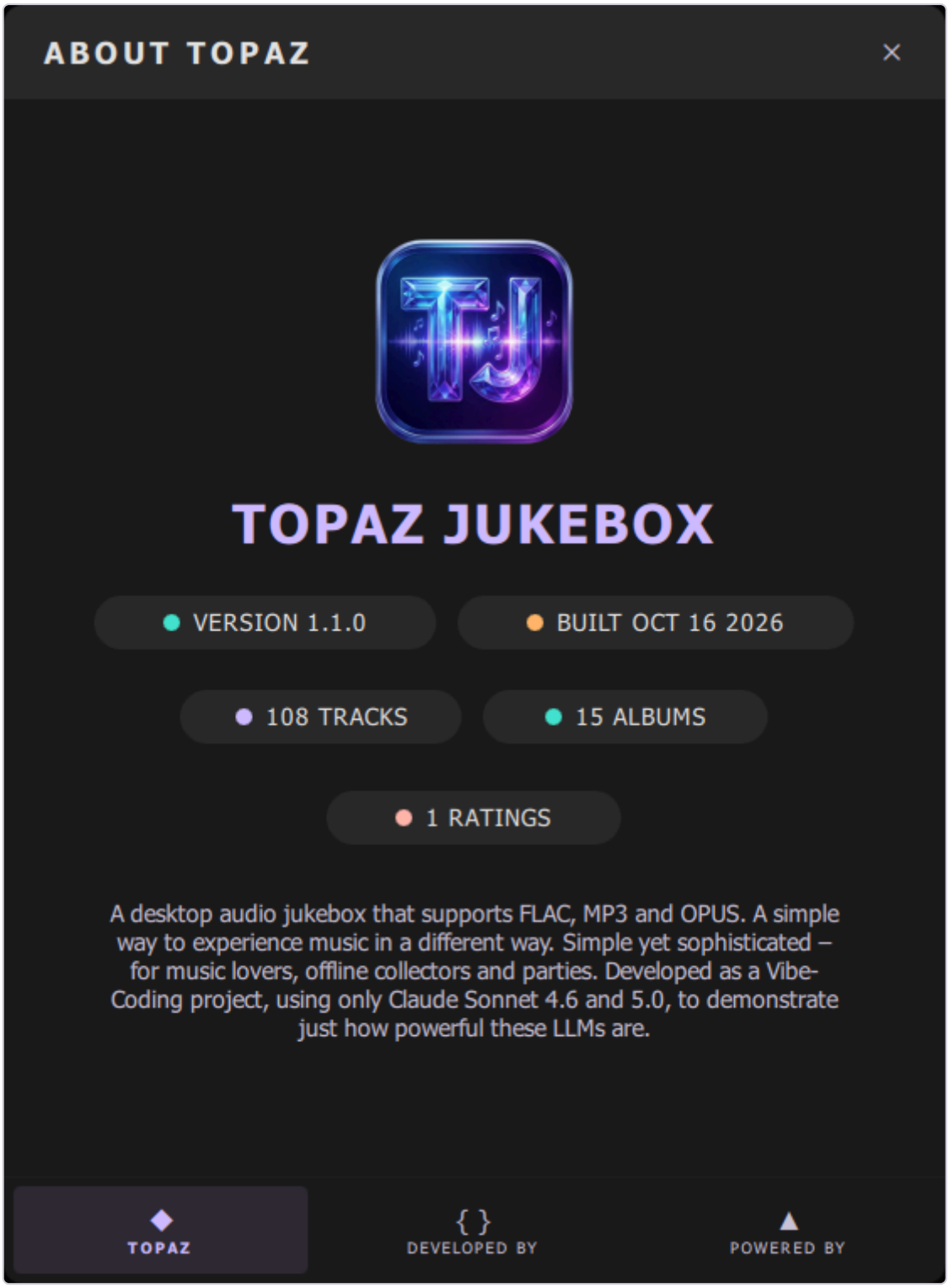
Backups are also a quick way to switch between completely different setups, for example one for your FLAC collection and one for an MP3 collection.

Other housekeeping

- **Remove Abandoned Ratings** — tidies up ratings of tracks you no longer have.
- **Cleanup Incompatible Milkdrop Presets** — removes preset files that Topaz can't display.
- **SCAN FOLDERS** — a full rescan of all active music folders.

About Topaz

The ⓘ icon in the top-right corner shows the version, the build date and some statistics about your library.


ABOUT TOPAZ
TOPAZ JUKEBOX
VERSION 1.1.0
BUILT OCT 16 2026
108 TRACKS
15 ALBUMS
1 RATINGS
A desktop audio jukebox that supports FLAC, MP3 and OPUS. A simple way to experience music in a different way. Simple yet sophisticated – for music lovers, offline collectors and parties. Developed as a Vibe-Coding project, using only Claude Sonnet 4.6 and 5.0, to demonstrate just how powerful these LLMs are.
TOPAZ
DEVELOPED BY
POWERED BY

Troubleshooting

The library stays empty. Check, in this order: the genre buttons are **active** (lit) · the genre is configured in Setup → GENRES, spelled like the files' genre tags · the music folder is in FILE MONITORING with **ACTIVE** ticked · then click **SCAN FOLDERS** in the bottom bar.

Some tracks are missing. Their genre tag probably doesn't match a configured genre. Remember that Topaz uses only the **first** genre of a multi-genre tag. Setup → GENRES → **SCAN FOLDERS** shows every genre exactly as it is spelled in your files.

"BASS Audio Library" can't be used. The BASS files are missing next to `Topaz.exe` / `topaz-bin`, or Topaz hasn't been restarted after switching the engine.

Auto Loudness Correction or Replay Gain Normalization is greyed out. Both need BASS as the **running** engine.

"Convert to MP3" is greyed out. Hover over it: either the playlist has no FLAC/Opus tracks, or no ffmpeg with the LAME encoder was found (next to `Topaz.exe` or on the PATH).

Milkdrop shows nothing. Add a preset folder on the MILKDROP tab. If it says MILKDROP UNAVAILABLE, your graphics driver doesn't offer OpenGL 3.3.

No AUTO PLAY notifications. They don't appear while Topaz is in full screen (Windows Focus Assist).

Linux: Topaz doesn't start. Start it with `./run-topaz.sh`, not `topaz-bin`. See `README-Linux.txt` for details.

I want to start over. Make a backup first. Then close Topaz and delete (or rename) its data folder — see Where Topaz keeps its data. Topaz starts like on the very first day.

Mouse and keyboard reference

Keyboard

Key	Action
F11	Main window: full screen on/off
F10	Milkdrop pane: full screen on/off
Enter	Setup → GENRES: add the typed genre · New Playlist: OK · selected pane: end fine-tuning
Esc	New Playlist: cancel · selected pane: end fine-tuning
Arrow keys · **Shift + arrow keys**	Selected pane (click it first): move it 1 px · 10 px

Mouse

Where	Action	Result
Album card — track	double-click	add the track to the queue
Album card — track	drag onto the queue	add the track to the queue
Album Browser — cover	double-click	add the whole album to the queue
Queue — row	click	play that track
Queue — row	↑ / ↓ / ✕	move up / move down / remove
Queue — track number	drag	move the track to another position
Queue header — ✕	click	empty the queue
NowPlaying — cover	click	open the Big Cover pane
NowPlaying — stars	click	rate the track (1–10)
NowPlaying — trash bin	click	delete the track's rating
Volume knob	drag / mouse wheel / click the speaker	set the system volume / mute
Any pane	drag / drag the edges	move / resize
Any pane	click	select it for fine-tuning with the arrow keys
Any pane	right-click	close the pane
Big Cover / Milkdrop pane	double-click	move across the screen
Tag Information pane	double-click	full width on/off
Panel dividers	drag	resize the panels
Scrollbar thumbs	drag	scroll